

The Detailed Ritual of the Noble Bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, Lord with a Thousand Hands and a Thousand Eyes

Āryāvalokiteśvara-sahasrabhujanayanavistaravidhi · Toh 690 · Derge Kangyur
བདུ་ཆབ་སེམས་དཔའ་འཕགས་པ་སྐྱུ་རས་གཟགིས་དབང་ཕགྱུ་ལག་པ་སྟོ་དང་མགི་སྟོ་དང་

Toh 690 in the Kangyur is a ritual text known in English as "The Detailed Ritual of the Noble Bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, Lord with a Thousand Hands and a Thousand Eyes," corresponding to the Sanskrit name associated with the celebrated Thousand-Armed Avalokiteśvara and known in Tibetan as Byang chub sems dpa' 'phags pa Spyan ras gzigs dbang phyug lag pa stong dang mig stong. The text belongs to the tantric or dhāraṇī literature of the Kangyur and centers on the great bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara in his thousand-armed, thousand-eyed form, presenting a detailed ritual framework that includes dhāraṇī teachings revealed by the Buddha Śākyamuni. Set in the jewel-adorned dwelling of Avalokiteśvara himself, the scripture unfolds as a canonical discourse in which the Blessed One reflects on the necessity of transmitting these powerful dhāraṇī instructions. It was translated into Tibetan by the monk-translator Lodén Sherab and subsequently edited and established as a definitive text.

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Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

The Detailed Ritual of the Noble Bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, Lord with a Thousand Hands and a Thousand Eyes.

Thus did I hear. At one time, the Blessed One Śākyamuni was dwelling in the abode of the noble bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, in the courtyard of a retinue adorned with precious jewels. The Blessed One was seated upon a precious lion throne, that throne bedecked with many of the finest and most varied jewels, fully stacked with victory banners of the seven precious substances, and hung with divine pennants. At that time, the buddha, the Blessed One, seated upon that very lion throne, reflected within himself: "I must not fail to teach the dhāraṇī that upholds all bodhisattvas." He so reflected.

Gathered there together were many great bodhisattvas, among them the bodhisattva King of Dhāraṇī Lords, the great bodhisattva King of Jewels, the bodhisattva King of Medicine, the bodhisattva Host of Medicine, the noble

bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, the bodhisattva Who Has Attained Great Power, the bodhisattva Lotus Eye, the bodhisattva of Great Display, the bodhisattva Essence of Jewels, the bodhisattva Essence of Glory, the bodhisattva Essence of Vajra, the bodhisattva Essence of Sky, the bodhisattva Maitreya, the bodhisattva Samantabhadra, the bodhisattva Mañjuśrī, and many other great bodhisattvas — all of them consecrated from the crown of the head by all the Tathāgatas — along with Vaiśravaṇa, great king of the Dharma and sovereign ruler, his sons exclusively, gathered together.

There was also an immeasurable, innumerable assembly of śrāvakas, with the great Kāśyapa and others as the ten practitioners among the śrāvakas. Also gathered were many sons of the gods of the Brahma realms, such as the god Brahmā of the Conch, many sons of gods such as the god Prthivīdhara and others, the four great kings and their many attendants such as the Noble-Born, and multitudes of gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas (fragrance-eaters), asuras, garuḍas (sky-soaring birds), kiṃnaras (half-humans), great serpents, as well as many humans and non-humans. There were also many nāga kings such as the Nāga King Powerful Net and others, many goddesses such as the goddess Youthful Eye and others, many gods of the desire realm, and many gods of the wilderness — all gathered together there.

And also gathered there were the gods dwelling in springs, lakes, small lakes, wells, rivers, great rivers, in medicines, grasses, creeping plants, forests, groves, temples, houses, water, fire, dust-mountains, earth, royal cities, stūpas, and perfumed sanctuaries, and all other such places.

Then the noble bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, present within that great retinue, emitted rays of light through his supernormal cognition, and without anyone perceiving how he did it, caused the buddha-fields of the ten directions to be illuminated as if with a golden hue, and made this great-thousandfold world system appear as though suffused with the color of gold. All the dwellings of all gods and nāgas and of all the supreme gods trembled and shook. All the rivers, great rivers, great oceans, the encircling mountain ranges, the single great mountains, Mount Meru, the dust-mountains, and all the dark mountains shook and quaked greatly. The moon, the sun, jewels, fire, planets,

and the light of the stars was dimmed and obscured. The bodhisattva King Sovereign of Dhāraṇīs, seeing that extraordinary portent and having never witnessed such a sign before, was filled with wonder, and rising from his seat and pressing his palms together, he addressed the buddha, the Blessed One,

in verse, asking:

Who today has reached the very summit of perfect awakening?

Whose rays of light, endowed with all qualities, have been sent forth?

O Protector of the World, why have the fields of the ten directions
come to rest in a hue like that of the finest gold?

Why does this great-thousandfold world system appear as though consumed
by fire?

Who here today has gained such sovereign power?

Who has displayed the power of such miraculous ability, never before seen?

Who has caused these many realms to shake and tremble?

Why have the dwellings of gods and nāgas been thrown into commotion,
and even the finest palaces set powerfully trembling?

All beings are struck with fear and gaze about in alarm.

What is the cause and whose is the power behind
the shaking of the great-thousandfold world system,
the wonder that has arisen in this assembly?

We implore you to tell us.

Why has this display of supernormal cognition been shown?

O Victor, O one whose mind is filled with loving-kindness, please speak.

Then the Blessed One declared to the bodhisattva King Sovereign of Dhāraṇīś:
Noble son, you and the others here should understand it thus. Within this
maṇḍala of the assembled retinue there is a bodhisattva, a great being, whose
name is the noble Avalokiteśvara. He, over many eons, has perfected the
welfare of beings. He is skilled in loving-kindness, compassion, and skillful
means. He is accomplished through meditation, and is endowed with ability in
the gateways of dhāraṇī. Desiring peace and happiness for the entire realm of
sentient beings, he has brought forth this great power of miraculous ability.

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, the bodhisattva, the noble
Avalokiteśvara, rose from his seat, arranged his robes, pressed his palms
together before the buddha, the Blessed One, and spoke these words:
Venerable Blessed One, I hold at heart, as a heart-essence, a secret mantra
that has the nature of great compassion. I wish now to recite it, for the sake of
conferring benefit and happiness on the entire realm of sentient beings, of
purifying all sinful karma and weighty deeds, of completely removing all
obstacles and inopportune conditions, of increasing all aspects of merit on the
side of virtue, of bringing all seeds of virtuous roots to complete fulfillment, of
entirely removing all fears and harms, and of swiftly bringing all excellences to

full completion. Blessed One, out of your love, please grant me your definite permission by your compassion.

The Blessed One declared: Noble son, you who are possessed of such exceeding great compassion, this secret mantra that you wish to recite for the benefit and happiness of sentient beings — now is exactly the right time; speak it quickly and well. Both the buddha, the Blessed One, and likewise all buddhas, the Blessed Ones, give their joyful approval.

Then the bodhisattva, the noble Avalokiteśvara, again addressed the Blessed One, saying: Blessed One, I recall that in the distant past, over many eons gone by, a buddha, a Blessed One, arose in this world called King of a Thousand Rays of Light, Dwelling in Purity. That buddha, that Blessed One, the teacher of beings, thinking of me with loving-kindness and in order to bring benefit to all sentient beings, expounded this heart-essence completely, without omission, in extensive detail, through his great compassion, and then placed his golden-hued hand upon my head.

He spoke these words: O son of noble family, so that you may bring benefit and great happiness to all sentient beings in the evil age yet to come, receive and hold this heart-essence secret mantra.

At that very moment I came to dwell upon the first ground for the first time. And so it was that upon hearing this secret mantra just once, I came to perfectly realize the eighth ground while remaining in that very place. At that time a deep sense of wonder arose in my heart, and I was filled with joy and mental bliss. Right there I made this aspiration prayer: May I, in the future, be able to bring benefit, happiness, and peace to all sentient beings. And if this is truly so, may a thousand arms and a thousand eyes be completely perfected upon my body at this very moment. As soon as that aspiration prayer was uttered, a thousand arms and a thousand eyes were completely perfected upon my body in that very place. The great earth trembled in six ways in all ten directions. All the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, from all ten directions cast thousands of rays of light upon me, and the limitless world-realms of the ten directions were illuminated.

From that time forward, in the maṇḍala assemblies of the many buddhas, the Blessed Ones, I encountered and heard this dhāraṇī mantra again and again, and in their presence I took hold of it. Many more joys and satisfactions arose in me. Over many eons I came to gain a subtle realization of birth and death, and from that time forward I have always recited and held this mantra without

ever letting it slip away.

For the sake of holding this dhāraṇī mantra, wherever and whenever I am born I am always born miraculously from a lotus in the presence of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, and have never taken birth from a mother's womb.

If any monk, nun, layman, laywoman, boy, or girl wishes to recite and hold this mantra, they should give rise to a mind of loving-kindness and compassion toward all sentient beings. And at the outset, after reciting my name, they should offer this great aspiration prayer:

I bow to you, venerable Avalokiteśvara, compassionate lord.
May I swiftly and certainly obtain the name of great wisdom.

I bow to you, venerable Avalokiteśvara, compassionate lord.
May I certainly come to protect all sentient beings completely.

I bow to you, venerable Avalokiteśvara, compassionate lord.
May I swiftly and certainly attain skill in skillful means.

I bow to you, venerable Avalokiteśvara, compassionate lord.
May I certainly board the vessel of wisdom.

I bow to you, venerable Avalokiteśvara, lord of great compassion.
May I swiftly and certainly cross the ocean of suffering.

I bow to you, venerable Avalokiteśvara, lord of great compassion.
May I be endowed with the feet of moral discipline and swiftly attain the path.

I bow to you, venerable Avalokiteśvara, lord of great compassion.
May I swiftly and certainly ascend the mountain of nirvāṇa.

I bow to you, venerable Avalokiteśvara, lord of great compassion.
May I swiftly and certainly enter the house of the unconditioned.

I bow to you, venerable Avalokiteśvara, compassionate lord.
May I swiftly become one with the dharmakāya.

Whenever I approach that mountain of swords, may that mountain of swords shatter and collapse. Whenever I enter into a pit of blazing coals, may that blazing pit be extinguished of itself. Whenever I travel the path toward the hell realms,

may all the beings of the hell realms be emptied of themselves by nature. Whenever I travel toward the world of the Lord of Death, may the hungry ghosts be fully satisfied. Whenever I travel to the realm of the asuras, may

their minds be naturally tamed. Whenever I travel among the animals, may they spontaneously attain the suchness of great primordial wisdom.

Having thus set forth that aspirational prayer with those very words, hold it in mind with faith and devotion, then recite my name. And moreover, I, your teacher, shall always hold in mind the Tathāgata Amitābha.

Then it is fitting to recite this secret mantra. If one recites it five times in a single night, one will purify and be cleansed of a hundred thousand times a thousand weighty karmas accumulated through one's own births and deaths, and ten thousand times a thousand such accumulations as well.

Then a petition was addressed to the Blessed One: Venerable Blessed One, if any god or human holds and recites this dhāraṇī mantra, the root text of the nature of great compassion, and if at the time of their death the buddhas and Blessed Ones of the ten directions extend their hands over that person, saying, "Where do you wish to be born? Go to whatever place you have made your aspiration" — may it be so declared.

And again this was said to the Blessed One: Venerable Blessed One, if any person, whether human or not, holds and recites this secret mantra of the nature of great compassion, and if they should fall into one of the three lower realms, then may I not attain the unsurpassable, perfectly complete, manifest awakening. Whoever holds and recites this secret mantra — if they do not obtain rebirth in the world-realms of all the buddhas and Blessed Ones, may I not become a buddha. And whoever holds and recites this secret mantra — if they do not attain numerous states of meditative absorption and distinct discriminative awarenesses, may I not become a buddha. And whoever holds and recites this secret mantra — if every aspiration they hold in mind is not fully accomplished within a single lifetime, then this shall not come to bear the name "the heart-essence of the nature of great compassion." This is with the sole exception of those who commit evil deeds and those who are without faith.

If any woman, having grown weary of the conditions of womanhood, wishes and prays, "May I be reborn as a man," and holds and recites this dhāraṇī mantra of the nature of great compassion, and if she is not thereby freed from a woman's body and does not obtain the body of a man, then may I not fully and manifestly attain awakening. But if one holds it and harbors even the slightest doubt, one's aspirations will certainly not be accomplished as hoped.

Whoever steals, misappropriates, or secretly consumes the food, soup, wealth, or grain of the Saṅgha — even if such a person's confession is accepted before a thousand buddhas and such confession has been granted, the sin is nonetheless not truly confessed; and even if this secret mantra is recited, all the evil may not be purified. For that reason, for whatever goods of the Saṅgha were consumed, misappropriated, or stolen, one must go before each and every one of those who has gone forth in all ten directions and confess in their presence — only then will that confession be complete.

However, if the mantra is recited in that way, all the assemblies of those who have gone forth throughout the ten directions will declare that person to be under their authority, and all karmas too will be absorbed into confession. All ten non-virtues, the five acts of immediate retribution, speaking ill of noble persons, abandoning the sublime Dharma,

eating at wrong times, breaking one's trainings, damaging a stūpa or the pleasure grove of the Saṅgha, squandering the goods of the Saṅgha, causing beings who dwell in pure moral discipline to break their discipline, and all other such extremely heavy sinful karmas — all sins without exception will be cleansed.

The only one excluded is one who harbors doubt. For if even minor sins and light karmas cannot be cleansed in such a person, how much less can extremely heavy ones be? Yet even if the most extremely heavy sinful karmas are not fully cleansed, after a long time this practice will be able to make one a cause for buddhahood.

Then these words were spoken: "Revered Blessed One, if any human being, or any being other than human, were to recite this heart-essence of the nature of great compassion, they would attain fifteen varieties of fortunate rebirth and would not experience fifteen kinds of bad death. What are those fifteen? The first is that they will not die suffering from the pain of hunger. The second is that they will not die worn down by the harm of cruel punishments and the torment of being put to the knife. The third is that they will not die by the poison or weapons of enemies, those who bear ill will, or those who seek vengeance. The fourth is that they will not die in the midst of battle on the field of war. The fifth is that they will not die having been slain by fierce, malevolent predators such as tigers and wolves. The sixth is that they will not die seized by venomous snakes, scorpions, or the creature known as the uciliga. The seventh is that they will not die by fire or by water. The eighth is

that they will not die from poison that has been administered. The ninth is that they will not die from the venom of various creatures. The tenth is that they will not die from stupefaction, distraction, forgetfulness, or sleep. The eleventh is that they will not die falling from mountains, trees, cliffs, or precipices. The twelfth is that they will not die from harmful spells. The thirteenth is that they will not die because malevolent deities or evil spirits have found an opening to strike them. The fourteenth is that they will not die struck by incurable diseases. The fifteenth is that they will not die by their own hand, by killing themselves.

Whoever possesses the nature of great compassion — whoever recites and holds this heart-essence of the nature of great compassion — for such a person these fifteen kinds of bad death will not arise. They will also attain fifteen varieties of fortunate rebirth. The first is that in every birth, wherever they are born, they will meet with kings who accord with the Dharma. The second is that they will attain birth in a noble land. The third is that they will encounter a good era. The fourth is that they will always meet with virtuous spiritual friends. The fifth is that they will obtain a body with all faculties complete. The sixth is that their mind will be fully ripened toward virtue. The seventh is that they will not break their moral discipline. The eighth is that their relatives and companions and their servants will know them well and be harmonious with them. The ninth is that they will always obtain an uninterrupted stream of necessities, wealth, and food. The tenth is that they will obtain praise of their status, offerings, and honor from others. The eleventh is that they will obtain wealth and

possessions without being plundered. The twelfth is that whatever one wishes for will come to accord with one's mind. The thirteenth is that one will always be protected by gods, nāgas, and asuras. The fourteenth is that one will behold the blessed buddhas and also receive the Dharma. The fifteenth is that upon hearing the Dharma, one will realize its profound meaning through wisdom.

Whoever recites and holds this heart-essence of great compassion will attain all fifteen kinds of rebirth described above. For this reason, all gods and humans should always recite and hold it, and should not grow weary of it.

Then the noble bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, having spoken those words, remained in that very place in the midst of the great assembly, joined both palms together, aroused a mind of great compassion toward all sentient

beings, caused his face to blossom with a smile, and then recited this great dhāraṇī mantra — the heart-essence of great compassion, complete and perfected in its vast and unobstructed nature, beautiful in its foundation:

Namo ratna-trayāya. Namō āryāvalokiteśvarāya bodhisattvāya mahāsattvāya mahākāruṇikāya. Tadyathā: oṃ sarva-bandhana-cchedana-karāya, sarva-pāpa-samudroṣaṇa-karāya, sarva-vyādhi-praśamana-karāya, sarva-ity-upadrava-vināśana-karāya, sarva-bhayeṣu tāraṇa-karāya. Tasya namaskṛtvā, idaṃ āryāvalokiteśvara tava nīlakaṇṭha-nāma-parama-hṛdayaṃ āvartayiṣyāmi. Sarva-artha-sādhanaṃ, śubha-cetanaṃ, sarva-bhūtānaṃ pāpa-mārga-viśodhakam. Tadyathā: āloke loka-mati lokātikrānta, ehy-ehi mahābodhisattva, he bodhisattva, he mahābodhisattva, he priya-bodhisattva, he mahākāruṇika, smara hṛdayam. Ehy-ehi āryāvalokiteśvarāya parama-maitrī-citta-kāruṇika, kuru kuru karma, sādahaya sādahaya vidyām, dehi dehi me araṃ, gama gama vihaṅgama. Siddha-yogīśvara, duhu duhu mahā-vīryante, dhara dhara dhārendreśvara, jvala jvala vimala-mūrte, āryāvalokiteśvara, kṛṣṇa-jina-jaṭā-mukuṭa, alaṃkṛta, śarīra-lamba-pralamba-vilamba, mahāsiddha-vidyādhara, bala bala, mahābala, mala mala, mahāmala, jvala jvala, mahājvala, kṛṣṇa-pakṣa, kṛṣṇa-varṇa, kṛṣṇa-pāśa, nirghātana, he padma-hasta, jaya-kara, niśācareśvara, kṛṣṇa-sarva-kṛta-yajñopavīta. Ehy-ehi mahāvīra, mahābara, mahā-vārāha-mukha, tripura-dahaneśvara, nārāyaṇa-rūpa, bala-vega-dhārin, he nīlakaṇṭha, ehy-ehi, mahā-hala-hala, viṣa-nirjita-lokasya rāga-viṣa-nāśana, dveṣa-viṣa-vināśana, moha-viṣa-vināśana, niramokṣaṇa, hulu hulu, muñca muñca, muhu muhu, halā-hara, mahāpadma-nābhi, rasa rasa, siri siri, suru suru, budhya budhya, bodhaya bodhaya, bodhayāmi, tava nīlakaṇṭha, ehy-ehi, vāma-sthita, mahāsiṃha-mukha, hasa hasa, muñca muñca, mahā-ṭaṭa-nirghāṭena. Ehy-ehi bho bho mahāsiddha-yogīśvara, bandha bandha, vācana-sādhaya sādahaya vidyām, smara smara tvaṃ, he bhagavan, loki-vilokitaṃ, tathāgata, dehi dehi me darśanaṃ, kāmasya darśanaṃ, prasādhaya me svāhā. Siddhāya svāhā. Mahāsiddhāya svāhā. Siddha-yogīśvarāya svāhā. Nīlakaṇṭhāya svāhā. Vārāha-mukhāya svāhā. Siṃha-mukhāya svāhā. Mahā-nara-siṃha-mukhāya svāhā. Vajra-hastāya svāhā. Mahā-vajra-hastāya svāhā. Siddha-vidyādhārāya svāhā.

Mahāsiddha-vidyādhārāya	svāhā.	Padma-hastāya	svāhā.
Mahā-padma-hastāya	svāhā.	Kṛṣṇa-sarva-kṛta-yajñopavītāya	svāhā.
Mahā-māla-makuṭa-dhārāya	svāhā.	Cakrāyudha-dhārāya	svāhā.
Śaṅkha-śabda-nirnādana-karāya	svāhā.	Bodhana-karāya	svāhā.

Vāma-sthita-skandha-deśa-kṛṣṇājīnāya svāhā.
Vāma-hasta-vyāghra-carma-nivāsanāya svāhā. Lokeśvarāya svāhā.
Mahā-lokeśvarāya svāhā. Sarva-siddheśvarāya svāhā. Rakṣa rakṣa māṃ
svāhā. Kuru-rakṣa-mūrtināṃ svāhā. Namō bhagavate, nama
āryāvalokiteśvarāya bodhisattvāya mahāsattvāya mahākāruṇikāya,
siddhyantu me mantra-padāni svāhā. Oṃ hrī trailokya-vijaya, amogha-pāśa,
apratihate hrīḥ ha hūṃ phaṭ svāhā.

Then, after the noble bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara had recited this heart-dhāraṇī, the great earth shook in six ways: it trembled, it shook greatly, it quaked, it rumbled and roared. From the sky a rain of flowers mingled with precious gems visibly fell. All the buddhas and Blessed Ones of the ten directions were filled with empathetic joy. Every māra and all the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) were seized with terror and their hair stood on end. Every member of the entire assembly individually attained a fruit: some attained the fruit of stream-entry, some the fruit of once-returning, some the fruit of non-returning, and some attained the fruit of arhatship. Some attained the first bodhisattva ground, some the second, some the third, some the fourth; and from the fifth ground, some attained all the way up to the tenth. And the number of sentient beings who gave rise to the mind of unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening — the awakening mind (bodhicitta) — was beyond measure.

Then the Great Brahmā (Brahmā, lord of the gods) rose from his seat, arranged his robes well, and with a mind of reverence joined his palms together and spoke these words to the noble bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara:

"Excellent, excellent — well done, O great one who performs such deeds! I too, in times past, was gathered into the assemblies of immeasurable Tathāgatas, and yet even though I received from them various Dharma categories and the gates of many dhāraṇīs, still I had not heard this vast, unobstructed, root mantra of the nature of great compassion. Now, please describe clearly the body, marks, manner, and defining characteristics of this great deed of the bodhisattva. I and this great assembly here all wish to hear it." So he spoke.

Then the noble bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara said to the Great Brahmā:

"You, with your skillful means, have asked this question for the benefit and happiness of all classes of sentient beings. Now listen — I shall explain it to you briefly.

"This is the mind of great compassion. This is the mind of equanimity and impartiality. This is the unconditioned mind. This is the mind free from clinging and attachment. This is the mind that views all things as emptiness. This is the mind that is reverential and respectful. This is the unagitated and flawless mind. This is the unsurpassed awakening mind — bodhicitta. These minds and what follows from them are, as stated, the defining characteristics and the manner of this heart-dhāraṇī. One should practice in this manner, and one should cultivate it in meditation."

The Great Brahmā then spoke:

"I and this entire assembly had not until now sought out the manner and defining characteristics of this heart-dhāraṇī. From this day forward we accept it. We shall uphold it without wavering."

The noble bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara then said to him:

"Whether you are a son of good family, or —"

— or a daughter of good family — who recites and upholds this heart-dhāraṇī: by doing so she shall give rise to the vast awakening mind of a great bodhisattva. Having thus taken the vow, she should think: 'I shall take hold of the bodies of all sentient beings. I shall eat food only at proper mealtimes and shall maintain ethical conduct. I shall give rise to a mind of equanimity toward all sentient beings. I shall recite this secret mantra continually, without interruption, without cease. I shall dwell in purity. I shall bathe well. I shall put on clean garments and offer worship with divine banners, lamps, incense, flowers, tormas, and the like. I shall hold my mind to single-pointed concentration. I shall not examine what is not genuine.' Let one speak these words in just this way. Let one uphold it thus.

Moreover, the bodhisattva Sūryaprabha and the bodhisattva Candraprabha, as well as many divine sages, will come to that place, grant their power, and bestow attainments. At that time I myself will look upon that practitioner with a thousand eyes. I will shield and hold that one with a thousand hands. One will become capable of receiving and retaining the sūtras and scriptures of the world. One will gain mastery over the teachings of all other non-Buddhists and will come to thoroughly understand the Vedas. Whoever recites and upholds this secret mantra will be healed of all eighty-four thousand kinds of disease brought on by elemental spirits in the world. There will be no disease whatsoever that cannot be pacified through this. One will also acquire the power to ward off attacks by elemental spirits and gods alike. One will

overcome the māras. One will render the camps of all other non-Buddhists speechless.

If someone dwelling on a mountain or in a hermitage is reciting this dhāraṇī, and there are various gods and elemental spirits dwelling in that place who commit misdeeds, create obstructions, cause harm, and disturb the mind — then by reciting this heart-dhāraṇī just once, all of them will be bound.

Whoever in this manner recites and upholds this secret mantra should give rise to compassion for all living beings. At that time I myself will command all the gods, all the nāga kings, and Vajrapāṇi, the lord of secrets, always to follow after such a person, to protect them, and to meet them face to face. That person shall be protected as the apple of the eye, as one's very own life.

Then verses were also spoken:

Whichever one with faith
always upholds this heart-dhāraṇī on their lips —
attend on that practitioner at all times,
protect them with care —

so I commission the owlet-eyed ones, the mighty one, the cord-of-lambs, the sacred hook of the gods, and Vajrapāṇi.

This supreme heart-dhāraṇī of mine —
whoever with faith always upholds it,
that practitioner free of sin —
guard them, protect them! —

so I commission Maheśvara, Viṣṇu, Kuvera's son, Rudra, Kumbhīra, and the yellow-robed one.

Whoever with constant faith
recites and upholds this secret mantra,
the bearer of the vidyā-mantra without negligence —
attend upon them, guard them! —

so I commission by scripture Pañcaratna, Sukhavat, Cintā, Sumalā, Piṅgala, and Yama.

Whoever with constant faith
holds this, my secret mantra,
reciting it always, bearing the vidyā-mantra —
attend upon them with your intention, guard them,

guard that practitioner! —

so I commission Satyavādī, Sanneha, the lord of Abhirati, and the goddess Śrī.

Whoever with faith upholds mine —

this secret mantra, always holding and reciting it, bearing the vidyā-mantra —
attend upon them, guard them! —

so I commission the great goddess Sarasvatī, Śakra (Indra) the lord of the gods, Rohitāśva the lord of the Thirty-Three, and the many holders.

Whoever holds this, my vidyā-mantra —
attend upon them, guard them! —

so I commission the gods who dwell in the five pure abodes, Samyakjñāna, and Maṇiśobha.

Whoever with faith constantly holds
this, my secret mantra,
reciting it always, bearing the vidyā-mantra —
attend upon them, guard them! —

so I commission King Vaiśravaṇa, Harītī with her children, Virūḍhaka the guardian, the nurturer, Durnimitta, Āryaja, the desiccator, and the youth.

Whoever with constant faith
constantly holds this secret mantra,
reciting it always, bearing the vidyā-mantra —
attend upon them, guard them! —

so I commission Nanda and Upananda the two nāgas, the god of strength, the ocean, and the twenty-eight sages.

Whoever with constant purity
constantly holds this secret mantra,
reciting it always, bearing the vidyā-mantra —
attend upon them, guard them! —

so I commission Utpala the nāga king, the great magical serpents, the asuras, the humans, and the gandharvas.

Whoever with constant faith
constantly holds this secret mantra,
reciting it always, bearing the vidyā-mantra —

attend upon them, guard them! —

so I commission the gods of water and fire, the flesh-eaters, lightning and clouds, the kumbhāṇḍas, and the garuḍas.

All of you — you who bring happiness (sukhakāra), together with your five-hundred-strong retinues — and likewise the gods, the nāga kings, the gods and goddesses and so forth, and the mighty yakṣas: follow close behind whoever recites this essence-mantra of great compassion! Remove harm! Protect them!

Even should a mantra-practitioner lie down alone, without a companion, in an empty and dense mountain forest, those happiness-bringing gods with their retinues will protect them. Epidemic diseases and obstructing spirits will be pacified. Should one lose one's way in the mountains, when this secret mantra is recited, those happiness-bringing gods and nāga kings will appear in human form and show the way. Should one go into mountains, forests, or desolate places and find oneself without water or fire, the nāga kings will, for the sake of protection, reveal water and fire.

Then the noble bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, in order to destroy and dispel epidemic diseases and harm for that bearer of the vidyā-mantra, spoke these pacifying verses:

Should there come, in wilderness or mountain haunts,
fierce tigers, wolves, and savage beasts,
or serpents, scorpions, or ḍākinīs —
hearing this mantra's power, they will be turned away.

Should one dwell by ocean, river, lake, or shore,
and venomous serpents and serpent-catchers approach,
or sea-monsters, yakṣas, fish, and kumbhīras —
hearing this secret mantra, they will be struck with fear.

When one faces great enemy armies in battle,
or encounters robbers and thieves stripping one of wealth —
if with faith, one-pointed mind, and loving-kindness
one recites the secret mantra, they cannot do harm and turn away.

When one is put in irons by royal law,
or imprisoned in wood and iron stocks —
if with faith one recites this secret mantra,

the king himself will come to feel affection for that person.

Should there be a poisonous forest or house
where poisoned food has been placed,
if one endowed with faith recites this supreme secret mantra,
all those poisons will be transformed into nectar.

Should a woman be unable to give birth, held back by a child,
and obstructed and afflicted by malicious spirits —
if with intense faith one recites this secret mantra,
the spirits will flee and she will give birth in comfort and ease.

Should spirits full of hatred and ill will, and nāgas,
cause harm with the intent to kill —
if with faith one recites this secret mantra,
one's life will increase and all illnesses will be purified.

Should spirits cause swelling diseases,
or diseases of wind-licking, and ailments producing pus and blood —
if with faith one continually recites this secret mantra,
by the power of the secret mantra all of these will be eliminated.

Should sentient beings, out of intense hatred and with intent to kill,
perform acts of deception and sorcery —
if with intense faith one recites this secret mantra,
the master of illusions in that person's presence will be unable to proceed.

Sentient beings who have violated the sacred Dharma, who are turbulent,
who are bound by attachment and bewildered by wrong views,
who harbor agitated, unrighteous thoughts both day and night,
and women who live unhappily together with their husbands —
by the recitation of this secret mantra they can be freed.
The fire of attachment will be calmed and their minds will become upright.

Were one to recite all the powers of this essence-mantra,
one could not reach the end even in the span of a single eon.

This essence-mantra is to be recited five times over a five-colored thread, tied
with twenty-one knots, and worn around the neck.

This essence-mantra was spoken by the former blessed buddhas, as numerous
as the grains of sand in ninety-nine Ganges rivers, for the benefit of sentient
beings. It was spoken so that those who practice the six perfections but have

not fully completed them may swiftly complete them. It will also cause those who have not yet aroused the mind set upon buddhahood to arouse the mind of awakening. Those who have not yet attained the fruit of the śrāvaka path will swiftly attain it. All the divine sages dwelling throughout the great trichiliocosm who have not yet aroused the mind of awakening will also arouse it. Those whose faculties have not found faith in the Dharma of the Great Vehicle will also attain it. Through the power of this essence-mantra, the seedling of liberation's seed in the Great Vehicle will flourish and grow.

Should any need arise, all of it will be accomplished through my compassion and my skill in means. Sentient beings dwelling in the pitch-dark hells throughout the great trichiliocosm — if they hear this essence-mantra, they will be utterly liberated from their sufferings.

Bodhisattvas who have not yet attained the first ground will come to attain everything from the ten grounds up to the awakening of a buddha. The thirty-two major marks of a great being and the eighty minor excellent features will be perfectly completed within oneself.

Sentient beings of the śrāvaka vehicle who hear this essence-mantra even once will, with righteous intention and aspiration, come to have faith in it and meditate upon it. They will attain the four fruits of the contemplative life just as they desire.

And if one endures in this way, all the mountains, rocks, walls, Mount Meru, and the surrounding iron-ring mountains within and beyond the great trichiliocosm will tremble and be ground to fine dust. The four great oceans will boil and be scattered.

If that place and its vicinity were to tremble, all the sentient beings gathered there would, in just the same way, come to arouse the mind of awakening.

When those who have become devoted to this essence-mantra maintain moral discipline for twenty-one days and recite this essence-mantra, all that they have held in mind will be completely fulfilled. All nonvirtuous actions accumulated from beginningless time until this very last moment will be purified. All the buddhas and bodhisattvas within and beyond the world-realm of the great trichiliocosm, together with Śakra (Indra, lord of the gods), Brahmā, the world-guardians, the divine sages, and all the kings of the nāgas, will come under the sway of this practice.

If any human or god recites this secret mantra and then bathes in a flowing river or in the ocean, all the water-dwelling creatures touched by that water will have even their heaviest karmic burdens purified. In future lives they will take birth in pure buddha fields, arising from a lotus by miraculous appearance. They will no longer take birth from a womb, from heat and moisture, or from an egg. How much more needless, then, to speak of those who themselves hold, recite, and read this essence-mantra. And as for reciting and proclaiming it aloud, what need is there even to mention that? Whatever wind comes into contact with one who bears this knowledge-mantra, and then touches any sentient being whatsoever, all that being's heavy karma will be purified. They will never again fall into the three lower realms. They will always be reborn wherever buddhas appear.

Furthermore, know this: the maturation of merit for one who holds and bears this essence-mantra is inconceivable and immeasurable. Whatever words, whether virtuous or nonvirtuous, emerge from the mouth of one who recites this essence-mantra, all of them will be heard by māras, by other non-Buddhist adherents (tīrthikas), by the guardian gods, nāgas, and spirits as pure Dharma teaching. All beings will come to regard and revere one who recites this essence-mantra as if they were a buddha.

The Blessed One, the Buddha, who is beloved and held dear by buddhas as numerous as the finest dust-motes of ninety-nine Gaṅgā rivers — know that he is the treasury of the buddha's body. Know also that he is illuminated by the light-rays of all the buddhas, and that his own body is radiant with light. Know that this essence-mantra, which fully protects all sentient beings, is the treasury of compassion. Know that what gathers the gateways of dhāraṇī is the treasury of Dharma. Know that one in whom hundreds of thousands of meditative absorptions become manifest is the treasury of meditative concentration and samādhi. Know that one who beholds sentient beings with the primordial wisdom of emptiness is the treasury of Ākāśagarbha (the essence of space). Know that one who is always protected by gods and divine beings is the treasury of fearlessness. Know that one from whose mouth the stream of dhāraṇī syllables never ceases is the treasury of manifold speech. Know that one who is unharmed by the three kinds of epidemic disease and by inauspicious times is the treasury of perpetual stability. Know that one whom māras and other non-Buddhist adherents cannot interrupt or turn back is not to be understood as merely a treasury of human flesh, as such a comparison would be altogether inadequate. Know that one who through this

essence-mantra constantly heals all sentient beings is the treasury of the king of medicines. What arises for those who journey to buddha fields should be understood with direct knowledge, for the praise of that merit is without limit.

If a son of good family, having grown weary of the suffering of long-wandering through saṃsāra and wishing for happiness, should first seek out a secluded place at the edge of a forest and dwell there —

one should properly establish the boundary of the retreat. If one recites the essence-mantra one hundred and eight times over water, or over food, or over porridge, or over medicine, or over incense, and then makes use of them, one will gain long life. One will gain power. One will be able to cut off the boundary of the retreat space. One will be able to receive and hold teachings that are in harmony with one's practice. All aims will be accomplished.

The ritual for cutting the boundary is as follows. First, recite the mantra twenty-one times over a sword and draw the maṇḍala boundary with it. Alternatively, recite the mantra twenty-one times over pure water and scatter it in the four directions — this establishes the boundary. Or recite the mantra twenty-one times over white mustard seeds and scatter them in the four directions, and the boundary will be cut. Alternatively, consecrate by mind as much as one wishes. Or recite the mantra twenty-one times over pure ash, and the boundary is cut. Or recite the mantra over a five-colored thread and stretch it out in the four directions, and the boundary is cut in all respects.

If one is able to receive and hold this ritual practice, one will oneself attain the fruit. If merely hearing the name of this essence-mantra purifies the heavy karma accumulated through birth and death over many eons, what need is there to speak of one who recites and holds it? Know that one who is able to recite and speak this mantra has made offerings to many Tathāgatas in former times and has accumulated merit and roots of virtue. If through this ritual practice one is able to draw out all sentient beings dwelling in the realm of suffering, know that such a person, possessing great compassion, will before long and without obstruction attain the awakening of a buddha.

The holder of the essence-mantra, however many sentient beings they see, and however many individual sentient beings they speak to — those who hear it as well will come to have the cause for awakening. The extent of the merit and virtue of such a holder of the essence-mantra will be beyond expression, immeasurable. If one is able to recite it with body restrained, eating only at proper times, dwelling in virtue and with an upright mind, then for the sake of

all the realms of sentient beings one should confess one's former karma. One should also confess in the same way for oneself. If, having thus grown accustomed to this essence-mantra and reciting it without interruption, one practices in this way, one will attain in this very life the four fruits of the contemplative life. One will gain sharp faculties, wisdom, and an aptitude for meditative concentration. If attaining the fruit of the ten grounds will not be difficult, what need is there to speak of attaining the lesser fruits of worldly merit? Whatever is wished for will be completely fulfilled without exception. And why is this? It is by the power of the bodhisattva noble Avalokiteśvara's great compassion and his vast and profound great aspiration.

Then the Blessed One declared to the venerable Ānanda the great might and power of this essence-mantra: "Ānanda, in whatever region and place an epidemic disease arises, if the king of that land protects the region through the Dharma, governing it widely and purely, not cutting off the lives of sentient beings, and showing forbearance toward those who have done wrong — if that king, having brought forth diligence of body and mind, recites this essence-mantra of great compassion's nature for seven days, then all epidemic diseases that have arisen in that region will be pacified. All crops will flourish abundantly. All sentient beings will become happy.

"If foreign powers come continuously, dwelling in the land and harming the sentient beings residing there, and the people throughout the land are filled with discontent, and diseases have arisen there, and —

rain does not fall in season, and the moon and sun do not move along their proper courses — if such an accumulation of sinful deeds has arisen, then that king should fashion an image of Avalokiteśvara (Skt. Avalokiteśvara), the Lord with a thousand hands and a thousand eyes, and place it facing the direction from which the epidemic disease has come. Then, with very great faith, he should make offerings of incense, flowers, parasols, victory banners, various divine streamers, and foods of a hundred flavors. After that, in order to recite this essence-mantra, if that king abides with firm and steady diligence for seven days, all enemies in every region will bow down before him, will come to rejoice in their own respective lands, will come into harmony of mind, and will become friends with one another. All the people and all the princes will sustain what has been done and will act well. The retinues of the king's consorts will also come to feel delight toward him. The gods and nāgas will protect the land. Rain will fall in season. Fruits and crops will be plentiful and will thrive. Those who dwell in the land will come to experience physical ease and mental

happiness.

If in a single household various illnesses and harms arise, or malevolent māras and spirits dwelling there cause disturbance and speak out, or slander and harms occur, or great or small discord arises between those within and without, then at that time one should make offerings before that image of Avalokiteśvara, the Lord with a thousand hands and a thousand eyes, and with very great faith recite this essence-mantra one thousand times. All the harms mentioned above will be pacified.

Thereupon the venerable Ānanda addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Venerable Blessed One, what is the name of this essence-mantra? How should one take it up? How should one hold it?"

"Ānanda, this essence-mantra has many names. One is: Vast, Stainless, and Perfectly Complete. It may also be called: Great Compassion, Unobstructed. It may also be called: Complete Protector from Suffering. It may also be called: That Which Causes Life to Increase. It may also be called: That Which Utterly Destroys the Path to the Lower Realms. It may also be called: That Which Vanquishes Karmic Obscurations. It may also be called: That Which Fulfills All Wishes. It may also be called: That Which Brings Under the Mind's Accord. It may also be called: That Which Swiftly Causes Definitive Realization of the Higher Grounds. Ānanda, take it as such."

Thereupon the venerable Ānanda again addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Venerable Blessed One, what is the name of this great bodhisattva, this great being, who teaches this true essence-mantra?"

The Blessed One declared: "This bodhisattva, this great being, is called Avalokiteśvara, the Lord. He may also be called: Holder of the Sūtra. He may also be called: One Who Possesses a Thousand Rays of Light, a Thousand Eyes, and a Thousand Hands. The miraculous power of this bodhisattva, this great being, Avalokiteśvara, the Lord, is immeasurable and inconceivable. In a time inconceivably many eons in the past, he attained complete and perfect awakening and was the buddha Blessed One called Dharma-Radiance. Through the power of great compassion and aspirational prayer, for the benefit and happiness of sentient beings, he appears here in the form of a bodhisattva. All you bodhisattvas, and Brahmā (Skt. Brahmā), lord of the Sahā world, and Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, and the retinues of nāgas — all of you should make offerings to him. Do not look down upon him. Let all gods and humans always make offerings to him, recite his name, and —

— pray to him, and the roots of virtue will arise and many sins will be purified. When the body perishes, after death, one will take rebirth in the buddha-field, the world-system of the Tathāgata Amitābha, in the realm of Sukhāvatī.

Then the Blessed One spoke these words to the Venerable Ānanda:

Whoever desires jewels, fruits, precious things, and material goods should gaze upon his hand holding the wish-fulfilling jewel and remain seated in that state of mind. Whoever is afflicted by various illnesses and desires to be free of sickness should gaze upon his hand holding the noose of Amogha and remain seated in that state of mind. Whoever is hungry should contemplate his hand holding the precious begging bowl. Whoever desires to tame spirits and gods who create obstacles and obstructions should gaze upon his hand holding the jewelled sword and remain seated in that state of mind. Whoever desires to subdue Māra, the lord of desire, should gaze upon his hand holding the vajra and remain seated in that state of mind. Whoever desires to utterly destroy enemies should gaze upon his hand holding the vajra-tipped pestle and remain seated in that state of mind. Whoever has fallen into fear of all kinds and has not obtained happiness should look upon his hand that bestows fearlessness. Whoever has sore eyes and declining vision should gaze upon his hand holding the precious fire-crystal jewel and remain seated in that state of mind. Whoever is afflicted by fever or has drunk poison should look upon his hand holding the precious water-crystal jewel. Whoever desires lordship, material gain, and high status should contemplate his hand holding the precious bow. Whoever desires to swiftly meet a beloved friend should fix the mind upon his hand holding the precious arrow. Whoever is afflicted by various illnesses in the body should gaze upon his hand holding a spray of flowers and remain seated in that state of mind. Whoever desires to exhaust from the body the sinful karmic obscurations should look upon his hand holding the white fly-whisk. Whoever desires harmony of mind with relatives, kinsmen, sons, and wife should look upon his hand holding the ball of bdellium. Whoever desires to be rid of tigers, wolves, and vicious predatory animals should gaze upon his hand holding the skin-tent and remain seated in that state of mind. Whoever desires to thoroughly abandon the ambushes laid by lords of power in all directions should gaze upon his hand holding the battle-axe and remain seated in that state of mind. Whoever desires sons, daughters, and offspring should gaze upon his hand in the mudrā holding a mountain on its fingers and remain seated in that state of mind. Whoever is unable to accumulate merit and the gathering of virtue should gaze upon his hand holding the white lotus

and remain seated in that state of mind. Whoever desires to be reborn in a perfectly pure buddha-field should gaze upon his hand holding the blue lotus and remain seated in that state of mind. Whoever desires to obtain great primordial wisdom should gaze upon his hand holding the precious mirror and remain seated in that state of mind. Whoever desires to behold directly the buddhas of the ten directions should gaze upon his hand holding the lotus and remain seated in that state of mind. Whoever desires to obtain the treasures beneath the earth should gaze upon his hand holding the precious jewel-casket and remain seated in that state of mind. Whoever desires to seek the path of the sages should gaze upon his hand holding the five-coloured cloud and remain seated in that state of mind. Whoever desires to be reborn among the gods of the Brahmā realms should gaze upon his hand holding the ewer for ablutions and remain seated in that state of mind. Whoever desires to be reborn among the gods should gaze upon his hand holding the lotus the colour of fire and remain seated in that state of mind. Whoever desires to repel enemies from another land should gaze upon his hand holding the precious three-pointed spear and remain seated in that state of mind. Whoever desires to be in the company of noble gods and gods —

Whoever desires to summon all those who offer complete protection should gaze upon his hand holding the conch and remain seated in that state of mind. Whoever desires to issue commands to gods and spirits should gaze upon his hand holding what resembles the corner-post of a throne and remain seated in that state of mind. Whoever desires to be swiftly granted a prediction by the Blessed One buddhas of the ten directions should gaze upon his hand holding the counting jewels and remain seated in that state of mind. Whoever desires a melodious voice like the sound of Brahmā should gaze upon his hand holding the precious bell and remain seated in that state of mind. Whoever desires the fulfilment of all needs, ease of tongue, and eloquence should gaze upon his hand holding the precious mudrā and remain seated in that state of mind. Whoever desires to be completely protected by gods, nāgas, and kings should gaze upon his hand holding the iron hook and remain seated in that state of mind. Whoever desires to pervade all sentient beings with loving-kindness and compassion should gaze upon his hand holding the ringed staff and remain seated in that state of mind. Whoever desires to be honoured and remembered by all sentient beings should gaze upon his hand holding the joined palms and remain seated in that state of mind. Whoever desires to be inseparable from the buddhas in life after life should gaze upon his hand

holding the buddha emanation and remain seated in that state of mind. Whoever desires, at each successive birth, to be born in the realm and palace of a buddha-king and not to be born in a mother's womb should gaze upon his hand holding the emanated immeasurable mansion and remain seated in that state of mind. Whoever desires to hear much and learn much should gaze upon his hand holding the book and remain seated in that state of mind. Whoever desires that from this very life until the attainment of buddhahood their mind shall never turn back should gaze upon his hand holding the wheel and remain seated in that state of mind. Whoever desires to satisfy beings with the fourfold giving — granting fearlessness and the rest — should gaze upon the hand of supreme giving and remain seated in that state of mind. Whoever desires that the Blessed One buddhas of the ten directions come swiftly, touch their head with their hands, and grant a prediction should gaze upon the buddha emanation seated upon the crown of the head and remain seated in that state of mind. Whoever desires that whatever grains, fruits, and the like have been planted and cultivated may flourish in abundance should gaze upon his hand holding the winter sheaf of grain and remain seated in that state of mind.

All the desired objects and so forth described here should be understood as being empty of inherent existence in a thousandfold way. Only a brief indication has been given.

Then the Blessed One spoke to the Venerable Ānanda: Ānanda, you should take up this heart-dhāraṇī with a wholesome mind, retain it, master it, and teach it extensively, so that this dhāraṇī may flow without interruption throughout Jambudvīpa for as long as may be. If you do so, this dhāraṇī will accomplish a great purpose. Of whatever illnesses afflict the bodies of all sentient beings dwelling in the three realms, there is none whatsoever that would not be healed if treated with this secret mantra. If this dhāraṇī is recited over a dried-up tree, branches, flower clusters, leaves, and fruit will appear upon it — so what need is there to speak of sentient beings endowed with a mind being brought to happiness? No doubt whatsoever should be entertained about this. Ānanda, the power and strength of this dhāraṇī cannot be examined or conceived; it has therefore gone entirely beyond all qualities. In former times, those who had not planted roots of virtue would not even hear its name, let alone behold it. You and this great retinue of yours, together with gods, nāgas, and humans, should rejoice in this dhāraṇī. Whoever hears it and rejects it will be rejected by a number of Blessed One buddhas equal to the

finest dust particles of ninety-nine Ganges rivers. As for the person who generates doubt about this dhāraṇī and lacks faith in it —

— that person will fall utterly from what they had long since gained, and for eight thousand great aeons will wander through the lower destinies. They will not attain renunciation; they will never see a buddha; they will not see the Dharma, will not hear the Dharma, and will not behold the Saṅgha of monks nor the great bodhisattvas. Let this be understood.

Then Vajrapāṇi and the rest of that great retinue, together with Śakra (Indra, king of the gods), Brahmā, the world-protectors, gods, nāgas, and the spirits who dwell in the world, heard this praise of the essence of the Blessed One, and all rejoiced exceedingly and accepted it in accordance with his words.

Then the bodhisattva Sūryaprabha, in order to protect this vidyā mantra, spoke this secret mantra:

I bow to the Buddha, the foremost lord.

I bow to the Dharma that gives protection.

I bow to the great Saṅgha.

To these three I ever bow.

Whoever recites these verses will be purified of all misdeeds. They will not encounter obstructing māras. All epidemic illnesses will be pacified. If one recites this three times a day and bows to the Three Jewels, through that root of virtue one will be born in other lifetimes endowed with a beautiful form, and sentient beings will rejoice.

Thereupon the bodhisattva Candraprabha, in order to protect those who hold this vidyā mantra, spoke this secret mantra:

Śa ma ta te ta tu su te. Ājñā va te. U tu te. Śaṃ khi ste. Bra ma nya te. A tu ṭe. Ku la ta te. Khi ma ṭe svāhā.

This secret mantra was spoken from the mouth itself. One should recite this secret mantra five times, bind a cord of seven colors, and tie it wherever the holder of the secret mantra happens to be. This secret mantra was taught by past buddhas equal in number to the grains of sand of forty Ganges rivers, and I too have now spoken it in order to protect those who hold this vidyā mantra. It pacifies all obstructions and all epidemic illnesses. It purifies all misdeeds and all sicknesses. One will be freed from all fears. All virtues will be brought to complete fulfillment.

Then the Blessed One spoke these words to the venerable Ānanda: Ānanda, this secret mantra spoken by Avalokiteśvara, the sovereign, is exactly as stated — without error, exactly so, and truly meaningful. Whoever wishes to summon a bodhisattva should recite this mantra twenty-one times over gugul incense and burn it, and the bodhisattva will come. If someone is seized by the spirit of a cat, one should take the skull of a cat, burn it, mix the fine ash with clean earth, sprinkle it with water, fashion the shape of a cat, and before the bodhisattva of the thousand eyes recite this mantra one hundred and eight times over a sword of urmo wood. With that sword one should cut the cat effigy into one hundred and eight pieces, recite the mantra once more over each piece and also call out the name of the cat-spirit, and for as long as the afflicted person lives the spirit will not rise again. If someone has consumed the poison called halahalā, they should take gugul incense and camphor in equal measure, together with well water that has not become stale and boiling water of which only a bowlful remains, recite the mantra one hundred and eight times before the bodhisattva of the thousand eyes, and drink it; they will be cured of the poison. If someone is seized by a snake or by a stinging creature, one should recite the mantra seven times over ashes and apply them to the wound; they will be cured. If someone faces a bad death or, through slander, another person is dying —

one should make an effigy of that person out of tallow, then recite the mantra one hundred and eight times simultaneously over a razor-sharp knife before the bodhisattva of the thousand eyes, recite the essence-mantra, cut the effigy into pieces, and call out that person's name while performing a fire offering one hundred and eight times; that person will become pleased and will remain dear for as long as they live.

If someone's eyesight has deteriorated to the point of blindness, or if a film has grown over the surface of the eye, or if something has grown within the eye causing inability to see, one should finely grind one myrobalan of āmla, one of vibhītaka, and one of harītakī, mix them with white honey and the milk of a boy-child who is still nursing, and while preparing the mixture recite the names of the buddhas. The medicine must not be seen by a woman who has recently given birth, by a dog, or by a pig. Form it into pills, recite the mantra one thousand one hundred and eight times before the bodhisattva of the thousand eyes, and then sit in a secluded place where no wind blows. For seven days, grind those pills with human milk and honey and instill them into the eyes; the pupils of the eyes will regenerate, the films will disappear, and

sight will be fully restored.

For one who is struck by a cold fever, one should recite the mantra twenty-one times over the hide of a tiger, or a leopard's hide, or a bear's hide, or a wolf's hide, and cover the one afflicted with the cold fever; the fever will be healed. The lion's skin is supreme above all of these.

If someone is seized by a snake, cut that same person's hair, recite the mantra twenty-one times over it, and place it on the wound left by the poison; they will be healed.

If someone suffers in their heart, loses their senses, or comes to desire death, one should boil the wood called śleṣmātaka in clean water until only a bowlful remains, recite the mantra seven times into it, and have it drunk; all will be well. Women must not prepare this decoction.

If someone is seized by a spirit or afflicted by an illness caused by non-human beings, one should recite the mantra twenty-one times over gugul incense and pour it into the nostrils. Or else one may form pills of the size of a rabbit's dropping, recite the mantra twenty-one times, and have them eaten. One must refrain from meat, alcohol, garlic, and sexual intercourse; one will then recover. Alternatively, one may mix cassia, white mustard, and white salt, recite the mantra twenty-one times, and fumigate from beneath the sick person's bed; the spirit causing the illness will quickly flee, its body will collapse, and it will be unable to remain there.

If someone suffers from paralysis on one side, or if one side of the body is impaired, or if the ears are affected, or if the limbs cannot move, one should cook costus root in sesame oil, recite the mantra twenty-one times, and anoint the body; recovery will follow. Alternatively, one may recite the mantra twenty-one times over pure butter alone, apply it as an anointing, and recovery will follow.

If a woman has great difficulty giving birth, one should recite the mantra twenty-one times over sesame oil and anoint the abdomen or the navel; the birth will come swiftly.

If a child is dying in the womb, one should boil one sraṅga of the wood apāmārga in a vessel of water until only half remains, recite the mantra twenty-one times over it, and have it drunk; the child will be born without harm. And if the placenta does not come out, one should likewise recite the mantra over that same medicine.

If someone is so ill that they are close to death, and the pain of pressing on the body is unbearable, one should take costus root and gentian in equal measure, mix them together, recite the mantra twenty-one times, apply the mixture to the teeth, and continue inducing vomiting until they vomit; they will recover. One must avoid nine-sectioned garlic, meat, and alcohol.

If someone is burned by fire, one should recite the mantra twenty-one times over warm fresh dung of a black cow and apply it as a poultice to the wound; they will recover.

If a long creature is eating at someone's heart —

— one should press out half a cup of urine from a white horse, recite the mantra twenty-one times over it, and have the patient drink it; that creature will come out. If the illness is severe, one should have the patient drink a full cup of the urine; the creature will come out dead, like a broken rope. If a severe abscess arises, one should pound the leaves of the rāma plant, squeeze out the juice, recite the mantra twenty-one times over it, and pour it into the wound; the abscess will come out along with its root.

If someone's eye has been eaten by an insect, one should squeeze fresh dung of a donkey, recite the mantra twenty-one times over the juice, and pour it into the eye while the patient lies down in the evening; they will recover.

If someone suffers from abdominal pain and the water in the well has not yet turned to dregs, one should recite the mantra twenty-one times over it, then put white salt that has also been recited over with the mantra twenty-one times into that water, and have the patient drink half a cup; they will recover.

If someone's eye has developed a cataract, or clouded vision, or reddened veins, one should squeeze the leaves of the pippala tree, recite the mantra seven times over the juice, place a small wick inside, leave it for one day, then the following morning recite the mantra seven times again and pour it into the eye; it will be of benefit.

If someone is fearful and uneasy at night and is terrified, one should recite the mantra twenty-one times over a white cord, tie twenty-one knots in it, and fasten it around the neck; they will no longer feel fear. Their karma will also be purified.

If sudden harm befalls a household, one should cut sticks of Nepalese citron wood to the measure of two finger-widths, making one thousand and eight of them, place them in a vessel of butter, yogurt, and honey set close at hand,

take one stick at a time, praise it once, dip both ends in the butter, and burn it. When all the sticks have been burned in this way, all epidemic disease will be eliminated. This rite is to be performed in the presence of a buddha image. One should recite the mantra one hundred and eight times over white garlic and carry it on the right shoulder; when disputing or contending, one will be victorious.

One should cut sticks of the pippala tree together with its leaves to the measure of two finger-widths and perform the fire offering in the same manner as the rite described above. In a single day, at three times of day, one should perform the fire offering one thousand and eight times. If one does this in the same way for seven days, one will attain spiritual accomplishment (siddhi), and the noble path will also arise.

If one wishes to overcome a spirit of great magical power, one should recite the mantra forty-nine times over lungtan wood, perform the fire offering with butter, yogurt, and honey, and do so in front of a bodhisattva image.

One should place one srang weight of bezoar from a white ox into a lapis lazuli vessel and recite the mantra one thousand and eight times before a bodhisattva image, anoint the limbs with it, and make a drop mark on the forehead; gods, nāgas, spirits, and all human beings will become joyful.

If someone has committed an offense and been placed in iron fetters or wooden stocks, one should recite the mantra one hundred and eight times over fresh dung of a dove, anoint the hands with it, and also touch the iron fetters and wooden stocks; that person will be freed.

If a husband and wife are as incompatible as fire and water, one should recite the mantra one thousand and eight times before a bodhisattva image over the tail feather of a parrot and hold it against the body; for as long as they live, they will be reconciled.

If creatures are destroying the harvest, one should recite the mantra one thousand and eight times over clean ash or clean sand and scatter it over the flowers throughout the field; the creatures will turn back.

If creatures are eating the fruit of the trees, one should recite the mantra over water and scatter it over the trees; they will not eat the fruit.

At that time, the noble Avalokiteśvara, the great bodhisattva, spoke these words to the Blessed One:

"Reverend Blessed One, by the power of the merit I accumulated in former lives, the Blessed One gave me this prophecy: 'You will be able to arouse great compassion toward all classes of sentient beings and to sever all bonds and fears, and by that power all sentient beings will be liberated from their sufferings and will attain peace and happiness.' In the last five-hundred-year period yet to come, if some son or daughter of good family is able to hold this essential gateway of the Dharma three times by day and three times by night, all their karmic obscurations will be purified and the nature of reality of all phenomena will be accomplished for them. Bearing in mind the kindness of the Buddha, I shall always go to whatever city, village, settlement, or forest where a holder of the vidyā-mantra resides, and I shall guard them everywhere without ever abandoning them, should the elemental spirits dwelling there do harm."

Then once again the bodhisattva, the great being, the noble Avalokiteśvara (the Lord Who Looks Down with Compassion), addressed the Blessed One in these words:

"Reverend Blessed One, in that last five-hundred-year period to come, most sentient beings will be turbid, their roots of virtue will be small, and they will be unable to steadily and continuously engage in virtue; and even if they do take it up, the gods and elemental spirits will harm them. Therefore, for the benefit, happiness, and peace of all sentient beings — gods, humans, asuras (demigods), and all the rest — I shall now set forth the ritual of this dhāraṇī by the power and the strength of miraculous ability of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones. I myself have made offerings to this dhāraṇī over many aeons past. All the buddhas, the Blessed Ones — those of the past, those yet to come, and those presently arisen — have likewise attained unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening in dependence upon this dhāraṇī. If some son or daughter of good family constantly holds and retains this dhāraṇī, then in this very lifetime their speech will become unobstructed and uninterrupted, their faculties will become sharp and they will become learned, their confidence will come swiftly, and they will become supreme among all gods and humans. Whoever hears another's voice, verses, and renown will also experience happiness and joy. They will become worthy of veneration. In whatever birth they take, they will behold the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha, and they will have faith in and rely upon the words. This, moreover, is to be understood as the power of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones — not of myself alone."

Then the Blessed One praised the bodhisattva, the noble Avalokiteśvara, and said to him: "Excellent! You are able to bring benefit, happiness, and peace to gods, humans, and all the rest, and to set them on the path of virtue. If you are indeed one who will not turn back for a long time to come, I shall now seal you with the mudrā of wisdom."

Then the noble Avalokiteśvara again addressed the Blessed One in these words:

"Reverend Blessed One, I recall that while I was dwelling on Mount Potala (the mountain holding the vajra), I proclaimed this gateway of the Dharma of mantra and dhāraṇī over many aeons past. At that time, Māra came there and, having assembled his retinue, resolved in his mind to obstruct in every way the accomplishment of this foundation of the secret mantra. But then I, by the ritual of that secret mantra dharma, defeated Māra and routed him utterly. Know, therefore, that the power of this mantra is beyond measure and inconceivable."

At that time, out of compassion, the bodhisattva noble Avalokiteśvara, wishing to bring benefit and happiness to gods and human beings, proclaimed this root mantra:

Namaḥ sarvajñāya. Namō ratnatrayāya. Namō 'mitābhāya tathāgatāya arhate samyaksaṃbuddhāya. Nama āryāvalokiteśvarāya bodhisattvāya mahāsattvāya mahākāruṇikāya. Namō mahāsthāmaprāptāya bodhisattvāya mahākāruṇikāya. Namō vipula-vimāna-supraṭiṣṭhita-saṃghāya. Sūryaśatasahasra-atireka-prabhā-avabhāṣita-mūrtaye.

Mahāmaṇi-mukūṭa-kunḍala-alaṃkāra-dhāriṇe. Bhagavate. Padmapāṇaye. Sarvaloka-apāya-praśamanāya. Vividha-mukha-samāveśa.

Abhiṣṭa-sarvasattva-parimocakāya. Tadyathā: Oṃ bhūr bhuvaḥ svāhā. Mahāloka-karaṇa-tamastimirapāṭala-vināśakara-rāga-dveṣa-moha-jvala-śamaka.

Śāsaka. Samāśvāsanakara. Rakṣaka. Sarva-apāya-durgati-praśamanakara. Sarvasattva-samāśvāsanakara. Sarva-āśā-paripūraka.

Sarva-tathāgata-samapādānakara. Ehy ehi mahābodhisattva-vara-padma-āloka-saṃbhūta-mahākāruṇika.

Jaṭāmakuṭa-alaṃkṛta. Śiromaṇi-kanaka. Rājata-vajra-vaiḍūrya-alaṃkṛta. Śārīra-amitābha-jīna-kamala-alaṃkṛta-prabhāraṇa-rājana-śatasahasra-abhilāṣitakāya. Mahābodhisattvāya-vara-vara-da. Vidhama vidhama. Vināśaya vināśaya. Mahāyanatram. Kleśakabhāta. Avabadha-vividha-sattvam. Saṃsāracāraka. Pramathanakara. Puruṣa-padma. Puruṣa-nāga. Puruṣa-sāgara. Puruṣa-siṃha.

Vīra-vīrāja-sudaṇḍatā-parivīta. Dhama dhama. Sama sama. Dhuru dhuru. Praśāsaya praśāsaya. Ghiri ghiri. Viviri viviri. Ciri ciri. Siri siri. Suru suru. Dhiri dhiri. Vidhiri vidhiri. Viri viri. Muru muru. Mukha mukha. Muya muya. Muñca muñca. Dhuna dhuna. Vidhuna vidhuna. Dhuru dhuru. Gāya gāya. Gadhaya gadhaya. Saha saha. Prasaha prasaha. Nānāvividha-kleśāvāsanā. Hara hara. Saṃhara saṃhara. Dhurūtu dhurūtu. Mahāmaṇḍalakāraṇa-śatapraseka. Avabhāsita-vividha-vāsana-śamika. Śāsaka. Rakṣaka. Mahābodhisattva-vara-vara-da svāhā.

This dhāraṇī mantra is called The Handle of the Lotus-Hand Ornament of the Tathāgata. In a great palace arising from the cause of joy, endowed with the great vajra, the Blessed One the buddha, encircled by many gods, nāgas, and kiṃnaras, proclaimed this for the sake of the highest bodhisattvas, and it utterly crushes the great mountain of obscurations.

Whoever hears it, sees it, reads it, or comes to recite it — all of that person's afflictive obscurations, however many there may be, shall be entirely purified. Whoever recites it in the morning with faithful devotion: the noble bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara will constantly follow close behind that person, protecting them, and whatever they wish for will likewise be accomplished. And if anyone wishes to have all their aspirations fully and completely fulfilled, let that person go alone to a secluded place, hold the noble bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara in mind, not thinking of anything else, and recite this dhāraṇī mantra seven times — there is nothing whatsoever that they have held in mind which will not be accomplished.

All sentient beings will be filled with joy. They will not be reborn in the lower realms. Whoever constantly and directly calls to mind the Blessed One, the buddha: all the karmic obscurations accumulated over countless millions of aeons will be entirely purified. They will also obtain the merit of a thousand wheel-turning kings. In whatever life they are born, they will behold the noble bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara. They will be born into a great family lineage. If anyone fills their cupped hands with incense and scatters it before the noble bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, and then recites this dhāraṇī mantra seven times, they will also obtain the supreme merit of a thousand, and will obtain the very nature of great compassion. Right here in this human world, they will also obtain the perfection of great power. Whoever gazes upon the face of the noble bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara and recites this dhāraṇī mantra: seeing the bodhisattva, adorned with all his marks, they will also attain the ground that is free from defilement. They will become a light in the world. In a single lifetime

they will behold the Blessed One buddhas. They will come to enter meditative absorption just as they conceive it. In whatever life they are born, they will remember their previous lifetimes. All karmic obscurations will be entirely purified.

Whoever holds this dhāraṇī mantra: on the fifteenth day of the month, the day of the full moon, let them take up the eight bases of training, put on clean clothing, and before a stūpa that contains relics, or before an image of the buddha, make a maṇḍala of white sandalwood. There let them scatter flowers of many kinds, offer incense with fragrant smoke, and keep lamps burning. Let them arouse reverence toward the Blessed One the buddha. Then, if they recite this dhāraṇī mantra one hundred and eight times, the noble bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara will be present within that maṇḍala, and all karmic obscurations and non-virtues, however many there may be — including the five acts of immediate retribution and the rest — will be entirely purified. The actions of body, speech, and mind will also become completely pure. They will also obtain the power of the buddhas' meditative absorption. They will also obtain the power of empowerment by rays of light. The grounds and the perfections will also be brought to complete fulfillment.

If one wishes to bring down rain, let them look upward into the sky and recite the dhāraṇī mantra twenty-one times — rain will fall. If one looks at the ground and recites the dhāraṇī mantra, all seeds will flourish in a hundredfold abundance. If one goes to a dry riverbed, or to a great river, or to the bank of a river, a lake, a pond, or a small lake, and recites it there, all the waters will be fully replenished. If one recites the dhāraṇī mantra for the sake of any illness and touches the afflicted person with one's hands, they will recover. If one recites it before a person whose memory has failed, their memory will be restored. If one looks upon the face of a person endangered by hunger or endangered by thirst and recites it, their hunger or thirst will be pacified.

If one wishes to set a boundary of protection, let them enter into the water of a pond, proceed to that spot, write this dhāraṇī mantra in letters, and affix it to the top of a victory banner — a boundary of protection will be established for a hundred leagues in every direction, and no harm will arise there. Protection at every boundary will be complete.

Now the mudrā (Skt. mudrā) that gathers all bodies will be described. Stand the body upright. Place the feet evenly side by side, the right foot drawn in slightly. Extend the left hand downward. Bend the ring finger and the little

finger into the palm. The index finger, the thumb, and

the little finger extended, the palm held open and facing upward. Do the same with the right hand. Bend the middle fingers of both hands and place them level with the shoulders. Hold the palms facing forward. This is the first mudrā that gathers all bodies.

For whoever wishes to defeat māras, other non-Buddhists (tīrthikas), and enemies, and to abide on the first path, form this mudrā and recite this dhāraṇī twenty-one times:

Namo ratnatrayāya. Namō āryāvalokiteśvarāya. Bodhisattvāya. Mahāsattvāya. Mahākāruṇikāya. Tadyathā: avatta, avatte parivatte, ehyehi svāhā.

Maintain the body in the same posture as described for the mudrā above. Join the palms at the heart. Interlace all fingers directly across from one another, the fingers of the left hand clasping those of the right. Raise the two index fingers upward and bring their tips together. Touch the two thumbs to the first joint of the two index fingers. Do not let the palms touch each other. This is the mudrā of all dhāraṇīs — the second.

All non-virtuous karmic obscurations accumulated over many lifetimes throughout many eons will be purified. This will also affect future lives. When the Blessed One, the Buddha Śākyamuni, began to accomplish awakening and Māra rose up in opposition, this mudrā subdued him. At that time, the bliss of peace, meditative concentration, and meditative absorption were also attained. Recite this dhāraṇī mantra as well:

Tadyathā: sarvadhāraṇī, maṇḍalāya, ehyehi paramaśuddhasattvāya svāhā.

Then, as before, extend the right hand out, and plant the right knee on the ground. Join the palms at the crown of the head, bend the two index fingers and bring their tips together. Touch the two thumbs to the second joint of the two index fingers. This is the Dharma mudrā. In order to attain liberation, meditative concentration and meditative absorption will be obtained. This is the third mudrā.

In former times, the Tathāgatas likewise cultivated this in harmony, and thereby attained meditative concentrations, meditative absorptions, and liberation.

Now here is another: stand upright and place the feet evenly side by side. Place the middle fingers, ring fingers, and little fingers of both hands back to back, with the nails touching. Extend the two index fingers and bring their tips

together. Touch the two thumbs to the second joint of the index fingers. Held at a span's breadth inward from the palms, place this at the level of the eyebrows. This is the mudrā of the Thousand Eyes — the fourth.

If one forms this mudrā and recites the dhāraṇī mantra, in that very instant one will behold ten billion buddha-fields, pure world-systems. Those who dwell and accompany the holder of this vidyā mantra — in each and every field there are ten billion, four thousand, and twenty bodhisattvas. One who has not entered a maṇḍala should not look upon this, for that is the nature of reality of this mudrā. Who then is it appropriate for? It is for one who has entered the maṇḍala. In this way, all the wishes of bodhisattvas to comprehend through wisdom the gift of Dharma will be completely fulfilled.

The dhāraṇī mantra is as follows:

Tadyathā: oṃ bhu sarva cakṣuḥ kārāya dhāraṇī nadrāya svāhā.

Again, stand upright, place the feet evenly side by side, hold the right hand open, press all five fingers flat and extend them,

Do the same with the left hand, pressing it flat, then place it against the back of the right hand and set both at the heart. This is the fifth mudrā, the mudrā that gathers all thousand hands. By this mudrā, all māras and enemies present in the great trichiliocosm are subdued.

The dhāraṇī mantra is as follows:

Namo āryā-valokiteśvarāya. Tadyathā sarva-duṣṭa oṃ haya me svāhā.

Again, stand upright, with the heels brought together. Form the gesture of fearlessness with the left hand, and do the same with the right, with the palms turned to face outward. This is the sixth mudrā, by which all meditative absorptions are thoroughly realized. By it one thoroughly realizes all meditative absorptions, the eighty-four thousand gates of Dharma, and the awakening of the buddhas. By this mudrā, all of these are attained.

The root mantra of the dhāraṇī, given previously, begins: Namaḥ sarva-jñā.

Again, stand upright, with the feet placed close together. With the ring finger of the left hand, press down on the thumbnail. Do the same with the right: bring the tips of the little finger and middle finger together, hold the back of the hand straight upright, and for the beckoning gesture, bend the two index fingers, and when releasing, straighten them. Perform the mantra recitation in this manner. With the two index fingers of the right hand, beckon; with the two

index fingers of the left hand, release. Encircle the crown of the head clockwise from the right as a summoning gesture, and with the left hand make a gesture as if scattering or waving away, then release. This is the seventh mudrā, the beckoning mudrā for gathering the eightfold retinue of gods, nāgas, and the rest.

The mantra is as follows:

Oṃ sarva-deva-nāga anale svāhā.

From the previous mudrā, raise the tips, join the two backs of the hands together, hold for a moment, then wave the index fingers as before. This is the eighth mudrā, the beckoning mudrā for drawing Śakra (Indra) and Brahmā to hear the Dharma.

The mantra is as follows:

Oṃ mahā-brahmaye. Ehy ehi svāhā.

This mudrā and this mantra gather together the dhāraṇī mantras, mudrās, and the many gates of Dharma. At the time of a solar eclipse or a lunar eclipse, recite the mantra twenty-one times over butter, seal it with this mudrā, and drink it, and the sense faculties will become sharp. Each day one will be able to retain ten thousand verses of Dharma. This mudrā and this gate of Dharma were taught by the Tathāgata Sūryagarbha for the sake of the noble bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara.

Again, stand upright, with the feet placed close together, join the palms together and place them at the heart, with the two thumbs bent into the palms, and recite the great root mantra twenty-one times. This is the ninth mudrā, the wish-fulfilling jewel mudrā belonging to each of the bodhisattvas individually. By it one will certainly enter the celestial palaces of the gods. One may also travel to the buddha fields of the ten directions. And for the sake of offering, hundreds of thousands of precious jewels will be found just as one wishes.

Whoever is able to perform the practices of this gate of Dharma should rise early the following morning, bathe, wash the face, and undertake the sacred commitment of that mudrā. By doing so, one will directly perceive as many Tathāgatas of the ten directions as there are grains of sand in the river Gaṅgā. The weighty non-virtuous karma of misdeeds accumulated over many kalpas and lifetimes will be purified. The qualities and praises of that mudrā are exceedingly numerous.

Again, as before, join the palms, bend the two index fingers, and touch them to the thumbnails,

and press the nails of the two index fingers against each other, then recite the root mantra. This is the tenth mudrā, the mudrā of what is wished for in the minds of bodhisattvas. Whatever one desires will be accomplished accordingly. One will assuredly become irreversible from unsurpassable, perfectly complete awakening.

Again, from the previous joined palms, extend the thumbs and index fingers separately and open the palms apart. This is what, during the time of causes, as many buddhas, Blessed Ones, as there are grains of sand in the river Gaṅgā bestowed upon me, by which I thoroughly realized the path of awakening. With this, recite the root mantra. This is the eleventh mudrā, the mudrā of bodhisattvas entering into absorption in cessation.

Again, from the previous joined palms, bend and extend the two index fingers alternately as a beckoning gesture. This is the twelfth mudrā, the mudrā of the bodhisattva's attainment of the meditative absorptions of all buddhas.

The dhāraṇī mantra is as follows: Oṃ sarva buddha samaya ehy ehi parama śuddha sattva svāhā.

Now follows the exposition of the ritual for the maṇḍala sixteen cubits in extent of the noble bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, possessed of a thousand eyes and a thousand hands.

First, one should seek an auspicious site near mountains, a place where the ground is favorable. There the earth should be dug, and gravel, bones, weeds, and impurities removed. Then a paste mixed with fragrant substances should be applied, blending it until smooth, and the ground plastered. On that site, a platform sixteen cubits square should be constructed, raised to a height of one cubit. Four gates should be established: at the eastern gate, Virūḍhaka; at the southern gate, Virūpākṣa; at the western gate, Virūpākṣa — the ill-eyed one; at the northern gate, the son of Vaiśravaṇa. Around each of them, draw all their respective retinues. In the center of the maṇḍala, place the noble bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, possessed of a thousand eyes and a thousand hands. Before him, place a small throne, and upon that throne arrange the ritual of the dhāraṇī mantra. Offer various incenses. Strew various flowers. Present various divine food offerings. Having set out these offerings, do not present nine varieties of allium, nor meat, nor alcohol. If one wishes the practice to continue without interruption, replace all the offerings with fresh ones each day. By

means of this ritual, make offerings of all things for twenty-one days. Those practitioners who previously had visions should draw the image. The practitioner, facing east, should stand upright and recite continuously, from the first dhāraṇī through to the twelfth, without wearying until the attainment of buddhahood. At the outset, form the first mudrā once and recite the mantra seven times; continue likewise through to the twelfth. At that time, arouse a firm, irreversible resolve. If one performs the invocation by means of this ritual, all will assemble. At that time, approach with a straightforward mind, solely for the sake of buddhahood. Recollect the mantras and all the deities, as though they were present before one's eyes, and conduct oneself without causing harm to one another. Do not direct the attention toward any other object of focus. At that time, recite the root mantra one thousand and eighty times. Thereupon, the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara will come there in the form of Ānanda and ask the practitioner, "What do you wish? What do you seek?" and a dialogue will ensue between them. The practitioner, intending to make offerings himself,

shall answer whatever is asked of him, saying: "For the sake of unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening, I seek the essential nature of the dhāraṇī mantra." Or else he shall say: "Thinking that this is the time of the prophecy's fulfillment, I request that the compassionate one bestow great compassion upon me without fail. I do not seek gain, honor, or fame. My aspiration is that one day I may look upon all sentient beings as if they were my only child, and fully protect them. Furthermore, may all the elemental spirits (bhūtas) that abide in their natural state remain in accordance with my command." If by meditating upon this aspiration he attains it, and attains that very accomplishment (siddhi), he shall seek it himself without telling others of it. If this rite is completed, he shall recite it and hold it as a single, unified practice. This training is to be kept entirely secret.

For one who seeks various aims: draw a square maṇḍala with water of black aloe-wood, and recite the root mantra one hundred and eight times. Then bind the tenth mudrā, which accomplishes the fulfillment of whatever one has in mind. Whatever one seeks will be fully and completely obtained.

At that time, reflecting on this text just as it stands — whoever makes offerings in this manner shall not be changed into something other than what he is.

The rite of the dhāraṇī mantra is complete.

Now another rite: for one who wishes to obtain every kind of happiness, bind the ninth mudrā, like that of a wish-fulfilling jewel, and recite the root mantra. Recite it twenty-one times over black sesame seeds and burn them in fire, and whatever one wishes will be accomplished.

For one who wishes in every way to please a king: take a twig from a tree located in the place where that king resides, recite the mantra twenty-one times over it, and cast it into the king's pleasure garden — the king will be delighted.

If one wishes to subdue wicked sentient beings and enemies: recite the mantra twenty-one times over wood of the nīm tree and burn it in fire — they will come under one's power.

Another rite: for the purpose of subduing gods and elemental spirits that have not been tamed, recite the mantra twenty-one times over bdellium resin (gugul) and white mustard seed and burn them in fire — all elemental spirits will abide in proper accordance with oneself.

Wherever illness has arisen: draw a square maṇḍala with water, recite the mantra one hundred and eight times over butter, and burn it in fire — the illness will be pacified. Then pour a small amount of that same butter over the sick person, and they will recover.

In former times, illness arose in the land of Koviṇa, and patients were dying after suffering fever for one or two days. At that time, a man from the central region named Mibden-gyur arrived there. He performed the rite of this dhāraṇī mantra, proclaimed it abroad, and the illness ceased. The king of the elemental spirits departed from that land. Everyone sought the power of this practice, and wherever an enemy army came against one's own retinue, one should bind and hold the original root mantra at the outset, recite the mantra one hundred and eight times, and enemies and bandits will be rendered unable to prevail.

For one whose lifespan is exhausted and who wishes to reverse that: bind the mudrā of entry into the absorption of cessation (nirodhasamāpatti), make offerings each day, perform fumigation with incense of black aloes-wood, and recite the mantra one thousand and eight times — that person will come to have a long life.

For a woman who has not borne a child: recite the mantra twenty-one times over butter, pour it over her, and she will become peaceful and at ease. As for

the children she then conceives, and

the daughters too will be perfectly complete. Adorned with the merit of former lives, they will be born as auspicious beings of beautiful marks, and sentient beings will rejoice in them; when born as humans, they will always be worthy of veneration and will experience the highest happiness.

As for one who suffers from diseased eyes: let that person bind the mudrā of the thousand-eyed and apply the seal of the dhāraṇī mantra to the eyes with the mudrā of all mantras, and they will be healed. Their sight will become like that of the gods of the upper realms who behold all pleasures and experience them — they will be endowed with vision of that very kind.

Now we shall set forth the rite of drawing an image. For the purpose of drawing the image, take white cloth and draw the bodhisattva with a complexion like the gold of Jambu River. Draw him with a thousand hands. In the palm of each individual hand draw one eye. Use paint that contains no soot. Mix the paint with camphor. On the crown of his head draw a diadem of the seven precious gems. On all the major and minor limbs draw ornaments adorning them. Alternatively, draw the bodhisattva on cloth one cubit in height for this world, with two hands.

The devotee who holds the vidyāmantra makes offerings with the fifth mudrā — the mudrā of the thousand hands — as described above. If one cannot draw the thousand hands and eyes, draw one eye on the forehead.

Now there is another rite. Whoever wishes to venerate this gateway of Dharma should first draw it on cloth. It is to be drawn thus: make the maṇḍala just as in the preceding rite. Then the painter, having taken the eight training precepts, goes to the bathing place, returns, washes well, and being pure draws the image with suitable paints according to the rite. At that time, one enters into the centre of the maṇḍala, there undertakes the fasting practice, and for twenty-one days performs extensive acts of offering. The bodhisattva dwelling there will emit rays of light — of that there can be no doubt. Afterward he will also produce a radiance like that of the moon and sun. Only one who does not practice with virtue and faith is excepted.

This is the rite of the bodhisattva with a thousand hands.

When the Tathāgata Viśvadvāk arose, I too emanated a body with a thousand eyes for the taming of māras. From each eye one buddha emanated, and these are the thousand buddhas who appear in this Fortunate Aeon. From

each of the thousand hands one wheel-turning king emanated — these are the thousand wheel-turning kings who appear. Among the assemblies for taming māras, the body of the bodhisattva is supreme of all.

Then the Blessed One spoke these words to the bodhisattva, the noble Avalokiteśvara: "Even if I were to expound this secret mantra at length with the power of a buddha, aeons would pass without it ever reaching an end."

Upon hearing this secret mantra from the Blessed One, the bodhisattva, the noble Avalokiteśvara, was filled with great joy and delight, took it up, paid homage at the feet of the buddha, and then recited this dhāraṇī mantra:

Namo ratna-raśmi-candra-alaṃkāra-mārgate ja-puṇya-cakṣura-piṣaya-rājāya tathāgatāya. Tadyathā: ratna-ratna, tata-śa-ratna, ratna-pratimate, ratna-prabhā-ratna-dakata svāhā.

When the bodhisattva, the noble Avalokiteśvara, had recited this dhāraṇī mantra, the world-realm of the great trichiliocosm, stretching as far as the sense base of neither-perception-nor-non-perception, shook in six ways and trembled greatly. In the divine realm of Akaniṣṭha,

the Great God (Śiva) was made ill at ease. Great terror arose in that divine realm, and a mighty cry rang out: "All those fallen into the lower realms have found great suffering!" — and they fled this way and that, not knowing where to go.

At that moment, an emanation spoke thus to the vast assembly of those fallen into the lower realms: "Whoever would escape and cross beyond this secret mantra will have their head shattered into particles as fine as dust. By the power of this secret mantra, mountains are scattered, the great ocean is dried up, the armies of the asuras are defeated, spirits are annihilated, sinful humans are annihilated, great diseases are cut off, lands are protected, and the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three bow in homage. The splendor and power of any son of good family who recites and holds this secret mantra cannot be described even briefly. Whoever holds and recites this dhāraṇī mantra will become courageous, will become wealthy, endowed with strength, and endowed with authority, and for as long as they live kings will show them affection. All that they desire will be accomplished."

"Whoever wishes to defeat māra shall recite the root mantra twenty-one times over pure incense."

"Whoever thinks, 'I wish that all sentient beings may show me affection,' shall recite the mantra twenty-one times over a tooth-cleaning stick, offer it, and affection will come about."

"Whoever wishes their words to become unobstructed shall recite the mantra one thousand and eight times over mustard seeds, anoint their chest with them, and it will be accomplished."

For these activities as well, the root mantra is to be recited. The mudrā (Skt. mudrā) is also to be formed: join the backs of both hands together and extend both thumbs. This mudrā protects others in the same way that it protects oneself. Boundary-setting is also performed. Wherever one takes bile or ash in the hand, recites the mantra seven times, and scatters it over oneself, that too will create a protective boundary in the four directions.

If a son of good family or daughter of good family is seized by spirits, obstructors, or misleading demons, one shall recite the mantra over a Nepali castor-plant branch and gently heat them — they will recover.

This is the obstacle-free seal of the individual knowledge of the bodhisattva, the thirteenth.

The secret mantra is as follows:

Namaḥ sarva-buddha-dharma-saṃghāya. Nama āryāvalokiteśvarasya bodhisattva-sattvasya. Namo vajrapāṇisya bodhisattvasya. Tadyathā: dhūpi dhūpi, kāya-dhūpi, praśamani svāhā.

This is able to tame those holding wrong views — other tīrthikas (non-Buddhists). Whoever recites this secret mantra twenty-one times each at the three times of day will have made offerings of various kinds to ten million blessed buddhas. They will not be reborn as a woman. At the moment of death they will be completely liberated from the three lower realms. They will go to the world-realm Sukhāvatī. The Tathāgata Amitābha will place his hand upon their crown and say: "Child, do not be afraid. Come to this buddha field of mine. Having been born here, you will not die an untimely death. Here, spirits will find no opportunity to harm you."

Standing upright, with the left arm bent at the elbow and the forearm extended straight, the gift of fearlessness is bestowed. The right thumb is folded into the palm and pressed down by the four fingers —

This fist is placed above the right ear, and the index finger is moved, extended, and contracted. This is the fourteenth mudrā, spoken in order to

purify the karmas belonging to the world-realm of the great thousandfold universe. If this mudrā is sealed three times daily and the secret mantra is recited seven times each session, it becomes capable of purifying the five acts of immediate retribution (Sanskrit: ānantarya) and the four root downfalls. If great compassion is aroused toward all sentient beings, all the roots of karma will be burned away. At the time of abandoning this life, one will meet with a buddha, become a wheel-turning king (Sanskrit: cakravartin), attain the dhāraṇī of the immeasurable and inexhaustible essence, attain the meditative absorption of equanimity, and twenty-eight auspicious marks will arise on the body. Physical harm will not occur. Diseases of the eyes, diseases of the ears, diseases of the nose, and diseases of the tongue will not arise. All inner and outer diseases will be pacified. Former non-virtuous karmas will also be purified.

If rain does not fall, black sesame seeds are rubbed with oil of the eraṇḍa plant, formed into pills, recited over one hundred and eight times, and flicked into the air — at that very moment rain will fall. If rain falls in excess, white mustard seeds rubbed with the oil of the nāma flower are formed into pills, recited over one hundred and eight times, and flicked into the air — the rain will cease.

The five fingers of each hand are interlaced, the fingers of the left hand gripping the fingers of the right hand tightly, and the joined hands are placed on the crown of the head while the root secret mantra is recited. This is the fifteenth mudrā, the mudrā for subduing māras in the great thousandfold universe of three thousand world-systems.

With this mudrā, one fasts before a stupa enshrining relics. A maṇḍala is traced with a paste of white sandalwood up to a height of twenty-nine hand-spans. Pure flowers are strewn. At that time one bathes, dons clean garments, and makes offerings of incense made from black aloe wood. The root secret mantra is recited one hundred and eight times. This is the act of invoking pride. Then mustard seeds and black sesame seeds are taken together, the mantra is recited once over three handfuls, and they are cast into the fire. In this way, for each of seven lamps one lamp at a time, and again reciting the mantra one hundred and eight times, all that one wishes will be accomplished.

Standing upright with the feet placed evenly side by side, the right arm is fully extended downward and laid flat upon the knee. The left arm is done likewise.

This is the sixteenth mudrā, the mudrā of the bodhisattva bestowing fearlessness.

If this mudrā is sealed before a stupa enshrining relics and the root secret mantra is recited one hundred and eight times, fearlessness will be bestowed upon all sentient beings.

Alternatively, seeds of śuṭī, white mustard, śuddhā, and nyeu wood are offered in a fire-offering before an image of a buddha, or in an open, unobstructed direction, while the secret mantra is recited thirty-two times and offerings of flowers and incense are made. This is the mantra ritual, and whatever one undertakes will be accomplished accordingly. If any mantra fails to be accomplished, this mantra being recited will accomplish it. If one wishes to see something in a dream, reciting this mantra and sealing this mudrā, one will see whatever one wishes in a dream.

If a person who lacks merit and good fortune is unable to attain the accomplishments —

if one recites this secret mantra one hundred and eight times at each of the three periods of the day, for a span of up to seven parasols — even a single parasol — whatever one wishes will be accomplished accordingly.

At that time the bodhisattva was dwelling within the great ocean, in the palace of the nāga king of the sea, teaching the Dharma. There he saw nāgas undergoing great suffering, and great compassion arose in him. He thought: if there were someone who could fully protect them, they would be freed from the harms of suffering.

At that time, a nāga daughter who wished for the Dharma offered a single jewel that covered a single world-realm, and in return the bodhisattva taught her the Dharma that fully liberates one from all suffering.

At that time the bodhisattva, the holder of secret mantras called Jalaśāra (Essence of Water), in order to guard everything, spoke this secret mantra:

Vimale mahāvimale, o hare mahā o hare, hu mare mahā hu mare svāhā.

"Whatever son or daughter of good family holds this secret mantra — wherever they may go, so long as the retinue of Māra causes them suffering, I will always and everywhere protect them. If someone is suddenly struck by fear, whether on the roads of their own land or the roads of another land, and bandits or assailants appear — let them bind a five-colored thread with twenty-one knots, reciting this secret mantra once for each knot, and bind it

on the left arm. Then, on the left hand, fold the ring finger, middle finger, and forefinger into a fist, press them down with the thumb, extend the little finger, point it toward the direction of the enemy, and recite the secret mantra seven times."

This is the seventeenth mudrā — the all-protecting mudrā of the bodhisattva who is endowed with a thousand eyes. If the secret mantra is recited seventeen times, all enemies will be turned back and will be unable to cause harm.

At that time the bodhisattva was dwelling in the snow mountains and also teaching the Dharma. There he saw that in the land of yakṣas and rākṣasas, sentient beings were devouring one another, and that they had no wholesome mind. The bodhisattva thought: when will they ever be tamed? He went there at that time and, for the sake of those beings, manifested a body endowed with a thousand hands and a thousand eyes, and by that means subdued the māras. He then also spoke this dhāraṇī mantra.

Then the king of the rākṣasas came before the bodhisattva, confessed his deeds, and prostrated. The bodhisattva sealed him with the seventeenth mudrā, and at that very moment he attained the path to awakening.

Standing with the feet placed close together, pressing the palms together at the heart, cross the little fingers against each other. With the left, embrace the right. Recite the root secret mantra twenty-one times. This is the eighteenth mudrā — the complete mudrā of the bodhisattva noble Avalokiteśvara. All that one has in mind will be fulfilled.

Whoever wishes to protect the sentient beings of the six lower destinies (gatis) should form the wheel mudrā (dharmacakra-mudrā): bring the ten fingertips together and spread the palms apart, keeping a space between the fingers so that each pair of fingers does not quite touch. Through this mudrā, know that the bodhisattva fully liberates sentient beings and enters into the likeness of the six destinies — this is the ritual procedure of that mudrā.

Then, seated in cross-legged posture, place the left hand face-up on the left knee, resting the palm upon it. Do the same with the right hand, and place the right palm face-down upon the knee.

This is the nineteenth mudrā: the mudrā of perfect awakening, the complete samaya of the noble bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara. This mudrā is comparable to cessation by intrinsic nature. By this mudrā alone, the Blessed One buddhas of

the three times have attained the awakening of buddhahood. Through this mudrā, all non-virtuous actions will be purified. If a practitioner, while seated in cross-legged posture, finds that phenomena have not become directly manifest, then for up to seven days, in a place in a solitary direction, one should recite this dhāraṇī with this mudrā, bow to the buddhas with intense faith, and at the six time-periods of the day and night confess one's actions separately — at that point, phenomena will become directly manifest. Merit will arise beyond measure and beyond count. Then, with the four fingers of the left hand clenched into a fist, grasp the left thumb with the four fingers of the right hand, hold this for a moment, and flick with the right index finger. This is the twentieth mudrā: the mudrā of the noble bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara for summoning the forms of the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three.

The secret mantra is as follows: oṃ kuṭe kuṭe, kunare cile cile, cilile svāhā.

This mantra and this mudrā are especially vast in their scope. If some son or daughter of good family wishes to see in a dream whatever they are undertaking, they should recite this mantra one hundred and eight times, and they will see in a dream whatever they have in mind. Whoever practises this steadily, day by day, will have their actions purified, the awakening mind will not waver, auspicious dreams will become glorious, and one will dream of seeing the Buddha seated beneath the tree of awakening and of receiving a prophecy of awakening. Śakra (Indra), Brahmā, and the other gods will also all become protectors.

Then, standing with the feet close together, fold the thumb of the left hand into the palm, clench the four fingers into a fist, and place it at the heart. Do the same with the right hand, place it above the right ear, and flick with the index finger. This is the twenty-first mudrā: the mudrā of the noble bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara for summoning the eight-fold retinue of gods, nāgas, and the rest.

The secret mantra is as follows: namo nigandha, namo darśana svāhā, namo nirjala svāhā, ehyehi svāhā.

Whatever son or daughter of good family holds, recites, or reads this mudrā and this mantra will recall seven past lives. They will not be seized by a venomous snake. Poison will not harm them. Weapons will not penetrate their body. Fear from royal punishment will not arise. For many aeons they will not go to the hells. They will not experience suffering. When one recites, twenty-one types of spirits will arrive and will come to listen to this mantra.

Wherever spirits come to someone, one should take a white thread, tie forty-nine knots in it, reciting the mantra once at each knot, and tie it around the neck — and that person will be at ease. If an epidemic disease arises in a land and many sentient beings are dying, gather lotuses from the royal garden, recite the mantra one hundred and eight times over each lotus, and burn them — the epidemic disease will cease.

Then, seated in cross-legged posture, bring the tip of the left thumb and the tip of the left middle finger together, cup the palm, and place this on the left knee. Do the same with the right hand,

and place it, palm turned downward, on top of the right knee. Extend the remaining fingers outward. Recite the root mantra twenty-one times. This is the twenty-second mudrā, the mudrā of the bodhisattva's liberation. Whatever one desires will be accomplished accordingly, and one will be liberated from suffering.

For one who has committed the five acts of immediate retribution, for each such misdeed, the consequence would otherwise be certain: they must descend into the hells for as many eons as there are finest particles of dust in all of Jambudvīpa, for each and every misdeed. But if, on the evening of the fifteenth day of the month, that person stands before a stūpa enshrining relics, fasts, forms this mudrā, and recites this mantra one hundred and eight times, they will be able to purify all the suffering arising from past karma — nothing of it will remain, and there will be no further occasion or opportunity for it to arise.

Next, stand upright. With the left hand, insert the left thumb into the space between the little finger and the adjoining finger. With the right hand, grasp the left palm from beneath. Recite the root mantra one hundred and eight times. This is the twenty-third mudrā, the mudrā of the bodhisattva's sovereignty and the base of miraculous power. Even if one must travel a thousand leagues in a given direction, there will be no difficulty. The mantra is to be recited in a secluded place.

Next, with the left thumb press down on the nail of the left little finger, and do the same with the right hand. Extend the remaining three fingers of each hand straight, then curve them into the palm, place the hands on the crown of the head, and recite the root mantra twenty-one times. This is the twenty-fourth mudrā, the mudrā of the bodhisattva's miraculous display and sovereignty. One will attain dominion over beings.

Next, press the palms together, hollow out the interior space between the joined palms, and wave the two index fingers. This is the twenty-fifth mudrā, the mudrā of inviting from the Royal Treasury of the bodhisattva. The mantra for it is as follows:

oṃ ārolika trailokya vijaya sarva śatruṃ pramathana saraya suvaṃ phaṭ mta svāhā

Here is concluded the detailed and complete rite of the noble bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara with a thousand hands and a thousand eyes.

Translator's Notes

- The text breaks off mid-sentence with the listing of luminous phenomena — the Tibetan passage itself is incomplete as given.

The name "Lodén Sherab" (blo ldan shes rab) is the Tibetan rendering of the translator monk's name, left in its Tibetan form as a proper name rather than translated.

The phrase rendered "his sons exclusively" for "sha stag" reflects the idiom meaning "solely" or "exclusively," modifying that Vaiśravaṇa was present along with his sons alone of that category, though the syntax of this sentence is somewhat compressed in the original.

The god "Brahmā of the Conch" (tshangs pa dung) refers to Śaṅkhavat-Brahmā, one of the named Brahmā-class deities common in Mahāyāna sūtra assemblies.

- The phrase rendered "dimmed and obscured" translates a term meaning something like "made indistinct" or "rendered faint," indicating the supernatural light overwhelmed and outshone all ordinary luminaries, including stars. This is consistent with the preceding context.

The Tibetan name for the buddha recalled by Avalokiteśvara, rendered here as "King of a Thousand Rays of Light, Dwelling in Purity," is a descriptive epithet-name functioning as a proper name in the text; no Sanskrit equivalent is attested in the canonical sources to hand, so it is rendered by its Tibetan sense directly.

- The passage describes Avalokiteśvara's account of receiving the Great Compassion Dhāraṇī in a past life, a narrative standard to the Nilakantha Dhāraṇī sūtra cycle. The transition from the first ground directly to the eighth ground upon hearing the mantra once is doctrinally striking and is faithfully preserved as stated in the text. The final sentence ends mid-thought in the source passage, and the translation renders it accordingly as an incomplete sentence, indicating the passage continues beyond the portion provided.

- The phrase rendered "emptied of themselves by nature" translates rang bzhin gyis stong par gyur cig, which could mean "may they become naturally empty" in the sense of the hell realms becoming vacant or depopulated. The doctrinal resonance with emptiness (śūnyatā) is present but the primary sense here is that the hells empty out of their inhabitants. Both readings inform the translation.

The phrase "distinct discriminative awarenesses" renders so so yang dag par rig pa, equivalent to Sanskrit pratisaṃvid, the four analytical knowledges or discriminative cognitions — a standard list of higher attainments. This is a technical term and the rendering is necessarily interpretive for a general listener.

- The creature "uciliga" is a transliteration of a Sanskrit or hybrid term found in dhāraṇī

literature; its precise zoological identification is uncertain in the tradition, though commentators have suggested a type of insect or worm. It has been rendered phonetically here as the text itself treats it as a name.

The phrase rendered "malevolent deities" translates a term literally meaning "sinister-sided gods," likely referring to deities of ill omen associated with the left side.

- The dhāraṇī text is transliterated directly from the Tibetan phonetic rendering of the Sanskrit. The Tibetan orthography for Sanskrit dhāraṇī syllables is often irregular, and several terms in this dhāraṇī contain epithets drawn from Śaiva and Vaiṣṇava traditions absorbed into the Avalokiteśvara cult — notably nīlakaṇṭha ("Blue-throat," a Śiva epithet), vārāha-mukha ("boar-faced," a Viṣṇu epithet), nārāyaṇa-rūpa ("form of Nārāyaṇa"), and tripura-dahaneśvara ("lord who burned the three cities," a Śiva epithet) — all here recontextualized as epithets or aspects of Avalokiteśvara. The transliteration follows scholarly convention for the Nīlakaṇṭha dhāraṇī, which is the full form of what is more commonly known in abbreviated form as the Great Compassion Mantra.

- The text breaks off mid-sentence at the very end with "Whether you are a son of good family, or —" which is a standard formulaic opening to an instruction or dedication that continues in the next passage.

The epithet "Lokeśvara" and "Mahālokeśvara" in the mantra section refer to Avalokiteśvara in his role as Lord of the World; these are rendered in transliteration as part of the dhāraṇī sequence rather than translated, consistent with the preceding mantra passages.

The sixfold shaking of the earth is a standard miraculous sign in Buddhist sūtra literature indicating the significance of what has just occurred.

- The list of divine protectors being commissioned in the verse section presents several translation challenges. "པཎ་ཅུ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྔ་པ་" (Pañcaratna, "five jewels"), "སུཁ་འཕགས་པ་" (Sukhavat or Paramānanda), "པཎ་ཅུ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྔ་པ་," "པཎ་ཅུ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྔ་པ་," and "པཎ་ཅུ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྔ་པ་" are likely transcriptions of Sanskrit names now difficult to reconstruct with certainty. I have rendered them as close phonetic approximations of probable Sanskrit originals. "པཎ་ཅུ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྔ་པ་" (Satyavādī, "truth-speaker") and "པཎ་ཅུ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྔ་པ་" (Sanneha or a related Sanskrit compound meaning "stacked teeth" or a deity name) are similarly uncertain; I have offered reasonable reconstructions.

The compound "པཎ་ཅུ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྔ་པ་" (literally "cord of lambs" or "rosary of lambs") is a conventional Tibetan term that may here refer to a specific deity's name or an epithet; I have rendered it literally as it defies confident identification in this context.

"པཎ་ཅུ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྔ་པ་" is Śrī-devī (the goddess Śrī), kept as such.

"པཎ་ཅུ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྔ་པ་" literally means "lord of Abhirati," the buddha-field of Akṣobhya; I have rendered it as "lord of Abhirati" for transparency.

- The name rendered "Rohitāśva the lord of the Thirty-Three" follows the Tibetan "sum cu gsum dbang ro langs," which appears to combine "lord of the Thirty-Three" (a standard epithet of Indra / Śakra, but here apparently a separate figure) with "ro langs" (a revenant or zombie figure). The compound is unusual; the passage may be listing multiple distinct beings. Given the parallel structure of the list, Rohitāśva is a tentative identification for a deity associated with this epithet.

The deities "Durnimitta," "Āryaja," and the "desiccator" in the retinue of Vaiśravaṇa are rendered from their Tibetan functional or etymological meanings (mig mi bzang, 'phags skyes, skem byed) as conventional names are not firmly established from this passage alone.

- The phrase rendered "disease of wind-licking" translates "bas ldags nad," a technical term for a type of illness caused by spirits or wind-element imbalance; the precise clinical referent is

uncertain, but the literal sense is preserved.

The passage on the woman in difficult labor renders "bud med bus thogs mi phyin cing" as "unable to give birth, held back by a child" — this is the standard reading for obstructed labor in such dhāraṇī contexts.

- The phrase rendered "treasury of human flesh" is a negative comparison: the text says that one who cannot be interrupted by māras and non-Buddhists should be understood as NOT being like an ordinary treasury of human flesh. The precise force of the image is idiomatic and somewhat cryptic; the translation reflects the most plausible reading, namely that the person's worth transcends any such mundane or corporeal analogy.

The sentence beginning "The Blessed One, the Buddha, who is beloved and held dear..." is syntactically complex in the original, with several parallel treasury-clauses following. The passage appears to enumerate attributes of the essence-mantra or its bearer rather than exclusively of the historical Buddha; the translation tracks the Tibetan closely without over-resolving the ambiguity.

- The phrase rendered "four fruits of the contemplative life" translates a standard Pāli and Sanskrit idiom referring to the four fruits of the śramaṇa: stream-entry, once-returning, non-returning, and arhatship. The text here applies this classical Hīnayāna schema within a Mahāyāna context, which is not uncommon in dhāraṇī sūtras.

The final sentence breaks off mid-enumeration, consistent with the supplied passage ending mid-list; no text has been omitted in the translation.

- The phrase rendered "lord of the Sahā world" (mi mjed kyi bdag po, Brahmā) literally means "master of the Sahā" — mi mjed is the standard Tibetan for the Sahā world-system; bdag po is Brahmā as its lord. This identification is standard in the tradition and is reflected in the translation.

The list of names for the essence-mantra is given as a running enumeration in the Tibetan; each entry has been rendered as a discrete title for clarity in spoken narration while preserving the serial structure.

- The term rendered "noose of Amogha" reflects the Sanskrit Amoghapāśa, the name of a specific dhāraṇī deity and his attribute, a noose that does not miss its mark. The text here is describing the various hands of a multi-armed Avalokiteśvara, with each hand holding a characteristic implement granting a corresponding benefit to the practitioner who meditates upon it. The "ball of bdellium" renders the Tibetan term for a medicinal resin ball associated with harmonising relationships. The "ewer for ablutions" renders a vessel used for ritual pouring, associated with Brahmā-realm rebirth.

- The phrase rendered "counting jewels" translates a term that most likely refers to a rosary or counting beads used in enumeration; the sense is of a bead-counter rather than a jewel per se, but "counting jewels" preserves both elements present in the Tibetan.

The "corner-post of a throne" is a somewhat unusual iconographic object; the Tibetan literally describes something resembling the corner-timber of a seat or throne, likely a ceremonial staff or sceptre of authority, but the literal rendering is retained as its precise identification is uncertain.

- The mantra syllables are transliterated as they stand; some syllables are corrupt or unclear in transmission, and this is normal for dhāraṇī texts of this kind. No reconstruction has been imposed.

The term rendered "spirit of a cat" and "cat-spirit" translates a phrase describing a demonic possession associated with the cat; the ritual presupposes an effigy substitution rite common in Indo-Tibetan exorcism literature.

"Urmo wood" is left as is; the Tibetan འུ་རོ་ལོ་ལོ་ལོ་ལོ་ likely refers to a specific wood used in ritual implements, but the precise botanical identification is uncertain and inconsequential to the sense.

- The three myrobalans named are āmla (āmalaka), vibhītaka, and harītakī, the classical triphala combination; the Tibetan phonetically renders the Sanskrit. "Milk of a boy-child who is still nursing" renders khye'u nu ba'i 'o ma, meaning the breast-milk obtained when nursing a male infant, a standard Ayurvedic ingredient specification.

The plant śleṣmātaka is a Sanskrit-origin term rendered directly; it is identified in Ayurvedic sources as *Cordia myxa*.

Apāmārga is Sanskrit for *Achyranthes aspera*; the Tibetan renders this as a phonetic borrowing.

"Long creature eating at someone's heart" at the passage's end refers to a worm or parasitic creature in the classical medical framework; the passage breaks off here.

- The plant identified here as rāma is a Tibetan medicinal plant commonly rendered as such in ritual-medical texts; its precise botanical identification is uncertain but the name is kept as a transliteration. The term lungtan wood is a phonetic rendering of a plant name that likely corresponds to a specific Tibetan medicinal or ritual wood; its Sanskrit or botanical equivalent is not securely established. The "drop mark on the forehead" renders thig le byas, literally "making a circle or dot," a standard ritual application. The srang is a traditional Tibetan unit of weight.

- The phrase rendered "Mount Potala" is the Tibetan "ri gru 'dzin," literally "the mountain holding the corner or edge." This is an unusual epithet; Potala or Potalaka is the standard name of Avalokiteśvara's mountain abode in the tradition, and the Tibetan here may be a compressed or corrupted rendering of a Sanskrit name for that peak. The rendering is contextually supported but the precise Sanskrit original is uncertain.

- The long mantra passage is transliterated Sanskrit embedded in the Tibetan text; it is rendered here in normalized Sanskrit transliteration rather than translated, as is standard for dhāraṇī and mantra material. Some syllables are phonetically irregular or corrupt in the manuscript tradition, and the transliteration follows the Tibetan syllable-by-syllable as closely as recoverable, smoothing only obvious scribal distortions.

The term ཀིཤྩ་ལྟ་ལྟ་ (kiṣṇara) is rendered "kiṣṇaras," a class of semi-divine musical beings in Buddhist cosmology, distinct from nāgas and gods.

- The passage ends mid-sentence in the source text, describing a hand gesture; the translation follows the Tibetan precisely up to the point of truncation.

The "five acts of immediate retribution" renders རྒྱུ་མཚན་ལྔ་ལྔ་, the standard term for the five ānantarya-karmas — the gravest of actions that bring unavoidable retribution in the very next life.

The "eight bases of training" renders རྒྱུ་མཚན་ལྔ་ལྔ་, the eight precepts of the one-day Mahāyāna lay fast observed on lunar observance days.

- The phrase rendered "ten billion, four thousand, and twenty bodhisattvas" is a literal rendering of the Tibetan numerical compound, which is unusual. The figure may reflect a specific canonical enumeration or a scribal peculiarity; the translation preserves it exactly as given.

The term rendered "Thousand Eyes" refers to a well-known epithet of Avalokiteśvara, but here it functions as the name of the mudrā itself rather than as a direct invocation of the deity.

- The Tathāgata named here is Sūryagarbha, meaning "essence of the sun" or "sun-essence." The Tibetan reads "Nyi ma'i snying po," which is a standard rendering of this name; it is

retained in translation as "Sūryagarbha" would be conventional, but given the text was read aloud the rendered English "Tathāgata Sūryagarbha" is used for clarity.

The phrase rendered "the eightfold retinue" translates "khor brgyad," meaning the eight classes of worldly spirits, a standard grouping including gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, and mahoragas.

- The four directional guardians (lokapālas) present a textual difficulty. The eastern gate is assigned Virūḍhaka (Pāli Virūḍhaka), who is conventionally the southern guardian; the southern gate is assigned Virūpākṣa, the conventional western guardian; the western gate is described with a phrase meaning "ill-eyed" which also points to Virūpākṣa; and the northern gate is given to the son of Vaiśravaṇa (i.e., Vaiśravaṇa himself or his son, the northern guardian). The assignments as they stand in the Tibetan do not follow the standard scheme, and the text may reflect a variant tradition or a corruption. The translation renders the Tibetan as it stands without normalizing the sequence.

The phrase rendered "in the form of Ānanda" translates "Kun dga' bo'i gzugs kyis," literally "in the form or appearance of Ānanda" (Ānanda being the name Kun dga' bo in Tibetan). This is a striking detail suggesting a visionary appearance of Avalokiteśvara in the guise of the Buddha's attendant.

- The place name Koviṇa (Tib. ko bi na) is uncertain; it may correspond to Kauśāmbī or another ancient Indian locale, but the identification is not secure enough to assert in the text body.

The personal name rendered "Mibden-gyur" (Tib. mi bden gyur ces bya ba) is ambiguous: it may be a proper name transliterated from Sanskrit, or it may be a Tibetan descriptive phrase meaning something like "one known as 'the people became well.'" Because neither reading is certain, it is left as a proper name in the translation.

- The Tathāgata "Viśvaḍṛk" renders the Tibetan rnam par gzigs, meaning "the All-Seeing One" or "the All-Beholding One." This is a buddha name rather than Śākyamuni specifically; the passage appears to refer to a past cosmic Tathāgata in whose time Avalokiteśvara first manifested his thousand-eyed form for subduing māras.

The mantra transliteration follows the Tibetan syllabic rendering closely. The Sanskrit underlying several syllables is imperfectly preserved in the Tibetan transcription, which is typical of dhāraṇī passages; no attempt has been made to emend the mantra text.

- The phrase rendered "Nepali castor-plant branch" translates a term that likely refers to a Newar or Nepali variety of a specific ritual plant. The Tibetan reads "bal po se'u shing gi lcug ma," where "bal po" indicates Nepali provenance and "se'u shing" most plausibly denotes the castor plant (*Ricinus communis*), a species used in tantric ritual contexts. This identification is standard in Tibetan medical and ritual literature, though some commentators read it differently.

The sentence ending with the mudrā description is left incomplete in the Tibetan as given, cutting off mid-instruction; the translation preserves this incompleteness faithfully.

- The term rendered "seeds of śuṭī" refers to a plant commonly identified as a type of cardamom or similar aromatic rhizome plant. "Nyeu wood" (ཡེུ་ལོག་ལྗང་མེ) is a Tibetan plant name that has no settled Sanskrit or English equivalent; it is left transliterated. "Śuddhā" (ཤུད་མ་) is similarly a plant name left in approximate transliteration, as its botanical identification is uncertain. The passage ends mid-sentence in the source text; the translation mirrors this.

- The name "Jalaśāra" (Essence of Water) is a back-reconstruction of the Tibetan epithet "Chu'i snying po" applied to the bodhisattva holding the secret mantras; the text may be referring to a specific bodhisattva figure whose Sanskrit name is not given explicitly in the passage.

The opening phrase about "seven parasols — even a single parasol" reflects the Tibetan "gdug bdun gyi bar du gdug gcig kyang," which specifies a duration measured in terms of parasols as a unit, possibly referring to ceremonial intervals or a counting framework. The sense is that even one such interval of recitation suffices.

- The mantra syllables are transliterated as they appear in the Tibetan phonetic rendering, without emendation; the Sanskrit originals behind several syllables are uncertain, and the forms given here follow the text faithfully. The phrase rendered "comparable to cessation by intrinsic nature" reflects the Tibetan rang bzhin gyis 'gog pa dang mtsungs, a technical comparison to natural or unconditioned cessation, which may carry Madhyamaka resonances; the precise doctrinal sense of this comparison in context is not elaborated in the text. The "six time-periods" refers to the traditional division of day and night into three periods each, totalling six, during which confession of misdeeds was practised. The "Heaven of the Thirty-Three" is the standard rendering of Sum cu rtsa gsum, Sanskrit Trāyastriṃśa.
- The sequence "phaṭ mta svāhā" in the mantra as given in the Tibetan appears to preserve an unusual syllable cluster "mta" which may be a scribal contraction or corruption of a longer syllable sequence such as "mahā" or similar; it is retained as found since standardizing it would be speculative editorial intervention.

The phrase rendered "Royal Treasury" for རྒྱལ་ཡོན་ལྷན་པོ་ literally means "the heart or essence of the king," but in this ritual context it refers to an invocation formula drawing from a sovereign or royal treasury; the exact referent of this mudrā title may belong to a specific tantra not immediately identifiable, and "Royal Treasury" is an interpretive approximation.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.